“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 1

The Auspicious Invocation: Obeisance to the Guru and Others

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. The chapter opens with fourteen verses that establish the truth (*tattva*). In verses 15–17 the author offers the *maṅgalācaraṇa*, the auspicious invocation, glorifying Śrī Madana-mohana, Śrī Govinda and Śrī Gopīnātha. The first of the fourteen verses is a general obeisance to six truths, and the whole chapter is nothing but its detailed explanation. The word “guru” means both the *dīkṣā-guru*, who gives initiation, and the *śikṣā-guru*, who instructs. The disciple must regard them as a manifestation (*prakāśa*) of Kṛṣṇa. The Lord’s devotees (*īśa-bhaktas*) are of two kinds: *siddhas*, who have reached perfection, and *sādhakas*, who are still on the path of practice (*sādhana*). The Lord (*Īśa*) is Kṛṣṇa in His original form, His *svayaṁ-rūpa*, together with His *kāya-vyūhas*, the expansions of His body. The avatāras are of three kinds: *aṁśa-avatāras*, *guṇa-avatāras* and *śaktyāveśa-avatāras*. In this connection the chapter examines the truth of Kṛṣṇa’s *prakāśa*, and with it the truth of *vilāsa*. Kṛṣṇa has three kinds of potency (*śakti*): the Lakṣmīs in Vaikuṇṭha and other abodes, the queens in Dvārakā, and, best of all, the gopīs of Vraja. Kṛṣṇa and His *kāya-vyūhas* are *īśa-tattva*, the truth of the Lord. All the devotees are *āvaraṇa-tattva*, His surrounding retinue, and are therefore a special potency of His. A potency and its possessor are eternally one when they are seen as non-different, and eternally distinct when the potency is seen apart from its possessor. Thus His inconceivable potency establishes one undivided Truth. This conclusion agrees with Vedānta, and its name is *acintya-bhedābheda-tattva*, the truth of

inconceivable oneness and difference. The last part of the chapter tells of the true nature (*svarūpa*) and greatness of Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda.

Śrī Caitanya, Nityānanda, Advaita — the root of prema — Haridāsa, Svarūpa Gosvāmī, Śrī Vaṁśīvadanānanda, Sārvabhauma, Rāmānanda, the two brothers Rūpa and Sanātana; Śrī Jīva, Gopāla Bhaṭṭa, Raghunātha — Dāsa and Bhaṭṭa, Śivānanda, Kavi Karṇapūra, Narottama, Śrīnivāsa, Rāmacandra, Kṛṣṇadāsa, Baladeva, and Cakravartī, the foremost. I have bowed with care to the Lord and His devotees, and in the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*, which gives the essence, I have explained the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* at length. O devotees, weigh it well! The stories of Gaura are an ocean; Kṛṣṇadāsa sailed upon it and brought back a stream of nectar. Vaiṣṇavas drink the nectar of this poem, their hearts grow peaceful, and they long to drink it again and again. Everyone told me, poor and destitute as I am, to compose a commentary on it. I took the sādhus' command upon my head, composed this commentary with care, and placed it in the sādhus' hands.

*The auspicious invocation begins. General obeisance to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya as the Truth (*tattva*) —*

বন্দে গুরূনীশভক্তানীশমীশাবতারকান্ ।
তৎপ্রকাশাংশ্চ তচ্চক্তীঃ কৃষ্ণচৈতন্যসংজ্ঞকম্ ॥ ১ ॥

vande gurūn īśa-bhaktān
I worship the gurus, the Lord's devotees
īśam īśāvatārakān
the Lord, the Lord's avatāras
tat-prakāśāṁś ca tac-chaktīḥ
His manifestations and His potencies
kṛṣṇa-caitanya-saṁjñakam
Kṛṣṇa Caitanya named

1 I worship the gurus, the devotees of the Lord, His avatāras, His manifestations and His potencies — and the Lord Himself, who is known as Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.[1]

Special obeisance to the two worshipful Lords: Nitāi and Gaura rise together

like the moon and the sun and show mercy to living beings —

বন্দে শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্যনিত্যানন্দৌ সহোদিতৌ ।
গৌড়োদয়ে পুষ্পবন্তৌ চিত্রৌ শন্দৌ তমোনুদৌ ॥ ২ ॥

vande śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-
I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya
nityānandau sahoditau
and Nityānanda who rose together
gauḍodaye puṣpavantau
on the eastern horizon of Gauḍa the sun and moon
citrau śan-dau tamo-nudau
wonderful bestowing good dispelling darkness

2 I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Śrī Nityānanda, who are like a wonderful sun and moon. They have risen together on the eastern horizon of Gauḍa, dispelling the darkness and bestowing good on all.

The Truth this book establishes. The one nondual Supreme Truth, Gaura-Kṛṣṇa, is perceived in three different ways —

যদদ্বৈতং ব্রহ্মোপনিষদি তদপ্যস্য তনুভা
য আত্মান্তর্য্যামী পুরুষ ইতি সোঽস্যাংশবিভবঃ ।
ষড়ৈশ্বর্য্যৈঃ পূর্ণো য ইহ ভগবান্ স স্বয়ময়ং
ন চৈতন্যাৎ কৃষ্ণাজ্জগতি পরতত্ত্বং পরমিহ ॥ ৩ ॥

yad advaitaṁ brahmopaniṣadi tad apy asya tanu-bhā
which non-dual Brahman in the Upaniṣads that also His bodily effulgence
ya ātmāntaryāmī puruṣa iti so 'syāṁśa-vibhavaḥ
who the Supersoul the Indweller the Puruṣa thus He His portion manifestation
ṣaḍ-aiśvaryaiḥ pūrṇo ya iha bhagavān sa svayam ayaṁ
with six opulences full who here Bhagavān He Himself this one
na caitanyāt kṛṣṇāj jagati para-tattvaṁ param iha
not than Caitanya Kṛṣṇa in the world supreme truth higher here

3 There is no Truth in the world higher than Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. That which the Upaniṣads call the non-dual Brahman is the effulgence of His body; the Puruṣa, the Supersoul who dwells within every heart, is His partial manifestation; and Bhagavān, full in all six opulences, is He Himself.

*The blessing, and the external reason for Gaura's descent — (*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 1, verse 2)*

অনর্পিতচরীং চিরাৎ করুণয়াবতীর্ণঃ কলৌ
সমর্পয়িতুমুন্নতোজ্জ্বলরসাং স্বভক্তিশ্রিয়ম্ ।
হরিঃ পুরটসুন্দরদ্যুতিকদম্বসন্দীপিতঃ
সদা হৃদয়কন্দরে স্ফুরতু বঃ শচীনন্দনঃ ॥ ৪ ॥

anarpita-carīṁ cirāt karuṇayāvatīrṇaḥ kalau
not given before for a long time out of mercy descended in Kali
samarpayitum unnatojjvala-rasāṁ sva-bhakti-śriyam
to bestow of the most exalted radiant rasa devotion to Himself the treasure
hariḥ puraṭa-sundara-dyuti-kadamba-sandīpitaḥ
Hari golden beautiful lustre with a mass illumined
sadā hṛdaya-kandare sphuratu vaḥ śacī-nandanaḥ
always in the cave of the heart may He shine your Śacī's son

4 "May the Lord Hari, the son of Śacī, illumined by a mass of lustre more beautiful than gold, ever shine in the inmost cave of your hearts. Out of His mercy He has descended in the age of Kali to bestow what had not been given for a very long time — the treasure of devotion to Himself, rich in the most exalted, radiant *ujjvala-rasa*." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 1.2)

The root purpose of Gaura's descent; the truth about Gaura — (from the diary

of Svarūpa Gosvāmī)

রাধা কৃষ্ণপ্রণয়বিকৃতির্হ্লাদিনীশক্তিরস্মা-
দেকাত্মানাবপি ভুবি পুরা দেহভেদং গতৌ তৌ ৷
চৈতন্যাখ্যং প্রকটমধুনা তদ্দ্বয়ং চৈক্যমাপ্তং
রাধাভাবদ্যুতিসুবলিতং নৌমি কৃষ্ণস্বরূপম্ ॥ ৫ ॥

rādhā kṛṣṇa-praṇaya-vikṛtir hlādinī śaktir asmād
Rādhā of Kṛṣṇa's love the transformation the pleasure potency therefore
ekātmānāv api bhuvi purā deha-bhedaṁ gatau tau
one in self although in the world of old bodily distinction attained the Two
caitanyākhyaṁ prakaṭam adhunā tad-dvayaṁ caikyam āptaṁ
Caitanya named manifest now that pair and oneness attained
rādhā-bhāva-dyuti-suvalitaṁ naumi kṛṣṇa-svarūpam
with Rādhā's sentiment and lustre adorned I bow to Kṛṣṇa Himself

5 "Śrī Rādhā is the transformation of Kṛṣṇa's love, His pleasure potency, *hlādinī-śakti*. Therefore, though Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are one in Self, from time without beginning They have appeared in the world in two different forms. Now these Two have become one and are manifest as Śrī Caitanya. I bow to Him, Kṛṣṇa Himself, adorned with the sentiment and the lustre of Śrī Rādhā." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)

The root purpose of Gaura's descent: three confidential reasons —

শ্রীরাধায়াঃ প্রণয়মহিমা কীদৃশো বানয়ৈবা-
স্বাদ্যো যেনাদ্ভুতমধুরিমা কীদৃশো বা মদীয়ঃ ৷
সৌখ্যঞ্চাস্যা মদনুভবতঃ কীদৃশং বেতি লোভা-
ত্তদ্ভাবাঢ্যঃ সমজনি শচীগর্ভসিন্ধৌ হরীন্দুঃ ॥ ৬ ॥

śrī-rādhāyāḥ praṇaya-mahimā kīdṛśo vānayaivā-
Śrī Rādhā's love's greatness of what kind or by Her alone
svādyo yenādbhuta-madhurimā kīdṛśo vā madīyaḥ
to be tasted by which wondrous sweetness of what kind or My
saukhyaṁ cāsyā mad-anubhavataḥ kīdṛśaṁ veti lobhāt
happiness and Her from experiencing Me of what kind or thus out of longing
tad-bhāvāḍhyaḥ samajani śacī-garbha-sindhau harīnduḥ
with Her sentiment rich was born in Śacī's womb ocean the moon Hari

6 "What is the greatness of Śrī Rādhā's love? What is My own wondrous sweetness, which She alone tastes through that love? And what is the happiness She feels in experiencing Me?" Longing to know this, the moon Hari, rich with Her sentiment, was born from the ocean of Śacī's womb. (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)

The truth about Śrī Nityānanda, and obeisance to Him —

সঙ্কর্ষণঃ কারণতোয়শায়ী
গর্ভোদশায়ী চ পয়োঽব্ধিশায়ী ।
শেষশ্চ যস্যাংশকলাঃ স নিত্যা-
নন্দাখ্যরামঃ শরণং মমাস্তু ॥ ৭ ॥

saṅkarṣaṇaḥ kāraṇa-toya-śāyī
Saṅkarṣaṇa Kāraṇodakaśāyī
garbhoda-śāyī ca payo'bdhi-śāyī
Garbhodakaśāyī and Kṣīrodakaśāyī
śeṣaś ca yasyāṁśa-kalāḥ sa nityā-
and Śeṣa whose portions and parts He Nityā-
nandākhya-rāmaḥ śaraṇaṁ mamāstu
-nanda named Rāma refuge my may be

7 "Saṅkarṣaṇa, the Lord who lies in the Causal Ocean, the Lord who lies in the Garbha Ocean, the Lord who lies in the Ocean of Milk, and Śeṣa are His portions and the parts of His portions: may that Rāma who is called Nityānanda be my refuge." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)

The five forms of Śrī Nityānanda. (1) His form as Saṅkarṣaṇa in Vaikuṇṭha —

মায়াতীতে ব্যাপিবৈকুণ্ঠলোকে
পূর্ণৈশ্বর্য্যে শ্রীচতুর্ব্যূহমধ্যে ৷
রূপং যস্যোদ্ভাতি সঙ্কর্ষণাখ্যং
তং শ্রীনিত্যানন্দরামং প্রপদ্যে ॥ ৮ ॥

māyātīte vyāpi-vaikuṇṭha-loke
beyond māyā in all-pervading Vaikuṇṭha world
pūrṇaiśvarye śrī-catur-vyūha-madhye
full of opulence amid the fourfold expansion
rūpaṁ yasyodbhāti saṅkarṣaṇākhyaṁ
form whose shines forth Saṅkarṣaṇa named
taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmaṁ prapadye
to Him Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma I surrender

8 "I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma, whose form called Saṅkarṣaṇa shines amid the fourfold expansion (catur-vyūha) in the all-pervading world of Vaikuṇṭha, full of every opulence and beyond māyā." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)

(2) The Supersoul, the cause of living beings and the world —
Kāraṇodakaśāyī, the first Puruṣa —

মায়াভর্ত্তাজাণ্ডসঙ্ঘাশ্রয়াঙ্গঃ
শেতে সাক্ষাৎ কারণাম্ভোধিমধ্যে ৷
যস্যৈকাংশঃ শ্রীপুমানাদিদেব-
স্তং শ্রীনিত্যানন্দরামং প্রপদ্যে ॥ ৯ ॥

māyā-bhartājāṇḍa-saṅghāśrayāṅgaḥ
māyā's master of universes multitudes shelter whose body
śete sākṣāt kāraṇāmbhodhi-madhye
lies in person of the Causal Ocean in the midst
yasyaikāṁśaḥ śrī-pumān ādi-devas
whose one part the Puruṣa the original Lord
taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmaṁ prapadye
to Him Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma I surrender

9 "I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma. A part of Him is the original Lord, the Puruṣa, the master of māyā, who lies in person in the midst of the Causal Ocean, His body the shelter of countless universes." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)

(3) The father of the lotus-born — Garbhodakaśāyī, the second Puruṣa —

যস্যাংশাংশঃ শ্রীল-গর্ভোদশায়ী
যন্নাভ্যব্জং লোকসঙ্ঘাতনালম্ ।
লোকস্রষ্টুঃ সূতিকাধামধাতু-
স্তং শ্রীনিত্যানন্দরামং প্রপদ্যে ॥ ১০ ॥

yasyāṁśāṁśaḥ śrīla-garbhoda-śāyī
whose part of a part the blessed Garbhodakaśāyī
yan-nābhy-abjaṁ loka-saṅghāta-nālam
whose navel-lotus of the worlds totality as its stem
loka-sraṣṭuḥ sūtikā-dhāma dhātus
of the creator of the worlds of birth the place of Brahmā
taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmaṁ prapadye
to Him Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma I surrender

10 "I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma. A part of His part is the blessed Garbhodakaśāyī, whose navel-lotus, with all the worlds as its stem, is the birthplace of Brahmā, the creator of the worlds." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)

(4) Kṣīrodaśāyī, the third Puruṣa; (5) Śeṣa, who holds up the earth —

যস্যাংশাংশাংশঃ পরাত্মাখিলানাং
পোষ্টা বিষ্ণুর্ভাতি দুগ্ধাব্ধিশায়ী ।
ক্ষৌণীভর্ত্তা যৎকলা সোঽপ্যনন্ত-
স্তং শ্রীনিত্যানন্দরামং প্রপদ্যে ॥ ১১ ॥

yasyāṁśāṁśāṁśaḥ parātmākhilānāṁ
whose part of a part of a part the Supersoul of all
poṣṭā viṣṇur bhāti dugdhābdhi-śāyī
the maintainer Viṣṇu appears lying on the Ocean of Milk
kṣauṇī-bhartā yat-kalā so 'py anantas
of the earth the upholder whose part He also Ananta
taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmaṁ prapadye
to Him Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma I surrender

11 "I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma. A part of a part of His part is Viṣṇu who lies on the Ocean of Milk, the Supersoul and maintainer of all beings; and Ananta, who upholds the earth, is a portion of that Viṣṇu." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)

The truth about Śrī Advaita, and obeisance to Him —

মহাবিষ্ণুর্জগৎকর্ত্তা মায়য়া যঃ সৃজত্যদঃ ।
তস্যাবতার এবায়মদ্বৈতাচার্য্য ঈশ্বরঃ ॥ ১২ ॥

mahā-viṣṇur jagat-kartā
Mahā-Viṣṇu of the world the maker
māyayā yaḥ sṛjaty adaḥ
by māyā who creates this (world)
tasyāvatāra evāyam
His avatāra indeed this
advaitācārya īśvaraḥ
Advaita Ācārya the Lord

12 Mahā-Viṣṇu is the maker of the world, who creates it through māyā; and this Lord Advaita Ācārya is His avatāra.

অদ্বৈতং হরিণাদ্বৈতাদচার্য্যং ভক্তিশংসনাৎ ।
ভক্তাবতারমীশং তমদ্বৈতাচার্য্যমাশ্রয়ে ॥ ১৩ ॥

advaitaṁ hariṇādvaitād
Advaita from Hari being non-different
ācāryaṁ bhakti-śaṁsanāt
Ācārya bhakti from teaching
bhaktāvatāram īśaṁ tam
as a devotee descended the Lord Him
advaitācāryam āśraye
Advaita Ācārya I take shelter of

13 He is called Advaita because He is non-different from Hari, and Ācārya because He teaches bhakti. I take shelter of Him, the Lord Advaita Ācārya, who has descended as a devotee.

*The intrinsic nature (*svarūpa*) of the Pañca-tattva, and obeisance to Them —*

পঞ্চতত্ত্বাত্মকং কৃষ্ণং ভক্তরূপস্বরূপকম্ ।
ভক্তাবতারং ভক্তাখ্যং নমামি ভক্তশক্তিকম্ ॥ ১৪ ॥

pañca-tattvātmakaṁ kṛṣṇaṁ
of five truths composed Kṛṣṇa
bhakta-rūpa-svarūpakam
devotee in form devotee in essence
bhaktāvatāraṁ bhaktākhyaṁ
the devotee-avatāra called a devotee
namāmi bhakta-śaktikam
I bow to the devotional potency

14 "I bow to Kṛṣṇa, who is manifest as five truths — the Pañca-tattva: as a devotee in form and a devotee in essence, as the incarnation of a devotee, as the one called a devotee, and as the potency of devotion." (Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī)[2]

Anubhāṣya.

At the very beginning the author wrote fourteen verses as the *maṅgalācaraṇa*, the auspicious invocation. In them he pointed out the subject this book establishes, blessed the listeners and offered them his respects. The first seven chapters of the Ādi-līlā explain exactly this, step by step and in detail.

*Obeisance to his own cherished Deity, the Lord of *sambandha* (relationship with the Lord) —*

জয়তাং সুরতৌ পঙ্গোর্মম মন্দমতের্গতী ।
মৎসর্ব্বস্বপদাম্ভোজৌ রাধামদনমোহনৌ ॥ ১৫ ॥

jayatāṁ suratau paṅgor
glory to the merciful (Pair) of the lame
mama manda-mater gatī
of me of dull mind the refuge
mat-sarvasva-padāmbhojau
whose lotus feet are my all
rādhā-madana-mohanau
Rādhā and Madana-mohana

15 All glory to the merciful Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Madana-mohana! I am lame and dull of mind, and They are my only refuge; Their lotus feet are all I have.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I am lame and dull-witted. My only refuge is the supremely merciful Śrī Śrī Rādhā-Madana-mohana, and Their lotus feet are all my wealth. May They be glorified!

Anubhāṣya.
Verses composed by the author himself —

paṅgoḥ (of one who cannot go elsewhere on his own feet, by his own strength) **manda-mateḥ** (of one whose small intelligence is absorbed in sense objects; of one who makes no effort in practices driven by other desires, karma, jñāna and the like; of one devoted exclusively [*ekāntin*]) **mama gatī** (my refuge: such are They for me. *Gati* is "that towards which one goes" [*gamyate*], that is, a shelter) **mat-sarvasva-padāmbhojau** (They whose lotus feet are all my wealth) **suratau** (merciful; or, boundlessly attached to each other) **rādhā-madana-mo-**

hanau (the Deities who bear these names) **jayatām** (may They abide in all Their supremacy).

*Obeisance to his own cherished Deity, the Lord of *abhidheya* (the means) —*

দীব্যদ্বৃন্দারণ্যকল্পদ্রুমাধঃ-
শ্রীমদ্রত্নাগারসিংহাসনস্থৌ ।
শ্রীশ্রীরাধা-শ্রীলগোবিন্দদেবৌ
প্রেষ্ঠালীভিঃ সেব্যমানৌ স্মরামি ॥ ১৬ ॥

dīvyad-vṛndāraṇya-kalpa-drumādhaḥ-
shining in Vṛndāvana forest wish-fulfilling tree beneath
śrīmad-ratnāgāra-siṁhāsana-sthau
in a beautiful jewel temple on a lion-throne seated
śrī śrī rādhā-śrīla-govinda-devau
Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Śrīla Govinda the Deities
preṣṭhālībhiḥ sevyamānau smarāmi
by Their dearest friends being served I remember

16 I remember Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Śrī Govindadeva, seated on a throne in a beautiful temple of jewels beneath a wish-fulfilling tree in the radiant forest of Vṛndāvana, served by Their dearest companions.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Śrī Rādhā-Govinda sit on a throne in a jewelled temple, beneath the wish-fulfilling tree of Vṛndāvana, a land of radiant beauty. Their dear companions serve Them. I remember Them.

Anubhāṣya.

dīvyad-vṛndāraṇya-kalpa-drumādhaḥ (at the foot of the wish-fulfilling tree in the radiant forest of Vṛndāvana. “Radiant” means supremely beautiful and enchanting to the mind) **śrīmad-ratnāgāra-siṁhāsana-sthau** (seated on a jewelled throne within a jewelled chamber of wondrous beauty) **preṣṭhālībhiḥ** (by Their dearest companions, devoted to service: the intimate confidantes [*priya-narma-sakhīs*] led by Śrī Lalitā, who are surrounded by Śrī Rūpa-mañjarī and others) **sevyamānau** (Those whom they serve) **śrī-śrī-rādhā-śrīla-govinda-devau smarāmi** (I remember Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Śrīla Govindadeva).

*Obeisance to his own cherished Deity, the Lord of *prayojana* (the goal) —*

শ্রীমান্ রাসরসারম্ভী বংশীবটতটস্থিতঃ ।
কর্ষন্ বেণুস্বনৈর্গোপীর্গোপীনাথঃ শ্রিয়েঽস্তু নঃ ॥ ১৭ ॥

śrīmān rāsa-rasārambhī
the beautiful of the rāsa dance's sweetness the initiator
vaṁśīvaṭa-taṭa-sthitaḥ
of Vaṁśīvaṭa on the bank standing
karṣan veṇu-svanair gopīr
drawing with the flute's sounds the gopīs
gopī-nāthaḥ śriye 'stu naḥ
of the gopīs the Lord for good may be ours

17 May the beautiful Śrī Gopīnātha, who begins the sweet rāsa dance, be our good fortune. Standing on the bank by Vaṁśīvaṭa, He draws the gopīs to Himself with the sounds of His flute.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrīmān Gopīnātha, who begins the rapturous rāsa dance, stands on the bank by Vaṁśīvaṭa and draws the gopīs with the sound of His flute. May He grant us what is auspicious.

Anubhāṣya.

śrīmān (He whose form is full of supreme beauty) **rāsa-rasārambhī** (He who begins the rapturous rāsa dance) **veṇu-svanaiḥ** (with the sounds of His flute) **gopīḥ** (the gopīs, the young cowherd women of Vraja) **karṣan** (drawing. He loosens in them every desire unrelated to Kṛṣṇa and, by the rope of prema that is His flute's sound, draws them out of their homes) **vaṁśīvaṭa-taṭa-sthitaḥ** (standing at the foot of the Vaṁśīvaṭa tree) **gopī-nāthaḥ** (He who sports freely) **naḥ** (for us) **śriye** (for the wealth of *prema*) **astu** (may He be).

জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ১৮ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaitacandra glory to Gaura's devotees host

18 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra, and glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

The three Deities whom the Gauḍīyas long to worship —

এই তিন ঠাকুর গৌড়ীয়াকে করিয়াছেন আত্মসাৎ ।
এ তিনের চরণ বন্দোঁ, তিনে মোর নাথ ॥ ১৯ ॥

ei tina ṭhākura gauḍīyāke kariyāchena ātmasāt
these three Deities the Gauḍīyas have made Their own
e tinera caraṇa vandoṁ, tine mora nātha
of these three the feet I worship; the Three my Lords

19 These three Deities have made the Gauḍīya devotees Their own. I worship Their feet: these Three are my Lords.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
These three Deities — Śrī Madana-mohana, Śrī Govindadeva and Śrī Gopīnātha — are the presiding Lords of Vṛndāvana. They gave the Gauḍīya devotees the right to serve each of Them, and so made them Their own.

Anubhāṣya.
The Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas serve the eighteen-syllable mantra. The Kṛṣṇa named in it is Madana-mohana; its Govinda is Govinda; and its Gopījana-vallabha is Gopīnātha. To realise Kṛṣṇa as Madana-mohana is *sambandha*. To serve Govinda is *abhidheya*. To be drawn by Gopījana-vallabha is *prayojana*. Śrī Mahāprabhu taught these three truths: *sambandha*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana*. These three Deities are forms of Bhagavān that embody those three truths, and They are the presiding Lords of Śrī Vṛndāvana.

The word *gauḍīya* means "of the land of Gauḍa." The part of Bhārata-varṣa south of the Himālayas and north of the Vindhyas is called Āryāvarta. It holds the five lands of Gauḍa: Sārasvata, Kānyakubja (Lakṣmaṇāvatī), Madhya-gauḍa, Maithila and Utkala. Many call Bengal Gauḍa, and the name "Gauḍa" belonged

above all to the capital of Bengal. Devotees from Utkala are called “Oriyā devotees,” and in the same way the people of Bengal are called “Gauḍīya.” The south, in turn, is known as Pañca-draviḍa, “the five Draviḍas.” All four ācāryas of the Vaiṣṇava sampradāyas were born in the land of Draviḍa. The Draviḍian Vaiṣṇavas took shelter of these ācāryas. So the word “Gauḍīya” may well have come into use from a wish to be distinguished from them. Śrī Rāmānujācārya was born at Mahābhūtapurī in southern Andhra; Śrī Madhvācārya in the village of Uḍupī in Paraśurāma-kṣetra, in the Mangalore district; Śrī Nimbāditya in the village of Muṅgerapattana in Dakṣiṇāpatha; and Śrī Viṣṇusvāmī in the land of Pāṇḍya. Śrī Mahāprabhu accepted the Śrī Mādhva-sampradāya. Yet the Vaiṣṇava ācāryas of the Tattvavāda branch, who hold to Madhva’s teaching, are Draviḍians. Therefore the sampradāya that has taken shelter at Śrī Gaura’s feet is called “Gauḍīya.” Moreover, Śrī Ānandatīrtha Pūrṇaprajña Madhvācārya has another name: Śrī Gauḍa-pūrṇānanda. So Śrī Gaura’s devotees may be called “Mādhva” as well as “Gauḍīya.”

The author explains his own auspicious invocation —

গ্রন্থের আরম্ভে করি মঙ্গলাচরণ ।
গুরু, বৈষ্ণব, ভগবান্ — তিনের স্মরণ ॥ ২০ ॥

granthera ārambhe kari maṅgalācaraṇa
of the book at the beginning I make the auspicious invocation
guru, vaiṣṇava, bhagavān — tinera smaraṇa
guru, Vaiṣṇava, Bhagavān — of the three remembrance

20 At the beginning of the book I make the auspicious invocation — the remembrance of three: the Guru, the Vaiṣṇavas and Bhagavān.

তিনের স্মরণে হয় বিঘ্নবিনাশন ।
অনায়াসে হয় নিজ বাঞ্ছিতপূরণ ॥ ২১ ॥

tinera smaraṇe haya vighna-vināśana
of the three by remembrance comes of obstacles destruction
anāyāse haya nija vāñcita-pūraṇa
easily comes one’s own desire’s fulfilment

21 Remembering these three, one overcomes all obstacles and easily attains one's heart's desire.

সে মঙ্গলাচরণ হয় ত্রিবিধ প্রকার ।
বস্তুনির্দ্দেশ, আশীর্ব্বাদ, নমস্কার ॥ ২২ ॥

se maṅgalācaraṇa haya tri-vidha prakāra
that invocation is of three kinds
vastu-nirdeśa, āśīrvāda, namaskāra
indication of the subject, benediction, obeisance

22 This invocation is of three kinds: indicating the subject, giving blessing and offering obeisance.

প্রথম দুই শ্লোকে ইষ্টদেব-নমস্কার ।
সামান্য-বিশেষ-রূপে দুই ত' প্রকার ॥ ২৩ ॥

prathama dui śloke iṣṭa-deva-namaskāra
in the first two verses to the worshipful Lord obeisance
sāmānya-viśeṣa-rūpe dui ta' prakāra
general and specific in form two indeed kinds

23 In the first two verses is the obeisance to the worshipful Lord, in two ways — general and specific.

তৃতীয় শ্লোকেতে করি বস্তুর নির্দ্দেশ ।
যাহা হৈতে জানি পরতত্ত্বের উদ্দেশ ॥ ২৪ ॥

tṛtīya ślokete kari vastura nirdeśa
in the third verse I make of the subject indication
yāhā haite jāni para-tattvera uddeśa
by which is known of the Supreme Truth the indication

24 In the third verse I indicate the subject, through which the Supreme Truth is made known.

চতুর্থ শ্লোকেতে করি জগতে আশীর্ব্বাদ ।
সর্ব্বত্র মাগিয়ে কৃষ্ণচৈতন্য-প্রসাদ ॥ ২৫ ॥

caturtha śloketе kari jagate āśīrvāda
in the fourth verse I give to the world blessing
sarvatra māgiye kṛṣṇa-caitanya-prasāda
everywhere I beg for Kṛṣṇa Caitanya's grace

25 In the fourth verse I bless the world, praying that the grace of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya may reach all.

সেই শ্লোকে কহি বাহ্যাবতার-কারণ ।
পঞ্চ ষষ্ঠ শ্লোকে কহি মূল-প্রয়োজন ॥ ২৬ ॥

sei śloke kahi bāhyāvatāra-kāraṇa
in that verse I tell of the external descent the cause
pañca ṣaṣṭha śloke kahi mūla-prayojana
in the fifth and sixth verses I tell the root purpose

26 In that verse I also tell the external reason for His descent; in the fifth and sixth verses I tell its root purpose.

এই ছয় শ্লোকে কৃষ্ণচৈতন্যের তত্ত্ব ।
আর পঞ্চ শ্লোকে নিত্যানন্দের মহত্ত্ব ॥ ২৭ ॥

ei chaya śloke kṛṣṇa caitanyera tattva
in these six verses of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya the truth
āra pañca śloke nityānandera mahattva
and in five verses of Nityānanda the greatness

27 In these six verses is the truth of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, and in the next five, the greatness of Śrī Nityānanda.

আর দুই শ্লোকে অদ্বৈত-তত্ত্বাখ্যান ।
আর এক শ্লোকে পঞ্চতত্ত্বের ব্যাখ্যান ॥ ২৮ ॥

āra dui śloke advaita-tattvākhyāna
then in two verses of Advaita the truth the account
āra eka śloke pañca-tattvera vyākhyāna
then in one verse of the Pañca-tattva the explanation

28 Then two verses tell the truth of Advaita, and one verse explains the Pañca-tattva.

এই চৌদ্দশ্লোকে করি মঙ্গলাচরণ ।
তহিঁ মধ্যে কহি সব বস্তুনিরূপণ ॥ ২৯ ॥

ei caudda śloke kari maṅgalācaraṇa
in these fourteen verses I make the invocation
tahiṁ madhye kahi saba vastu-nirūpaṇa
within them I tell the whole subject's description

29 In these fourteen verses I make the auspicious invocation, and within them I describe the whole subject.

সব শ্রোতা-বৈষ্ণবেরে করি' নমস্কার ।
এই সব শ্লোকের করি অর্থ-বিচার ॥ ৩০ ॥

saba śrotā-vaiṣṇavere kari' namaskāra
to all listening Vaiṣṇavas offering obeisance
ei saba ślokera kari artha-vicāra
of all these verses I make of the meaning consideration

30 Offering obeisance to all the Vaiṣṇavas who hear this, I shall now consider the meaning of all these verses.

সকল বৈষ্ণব, শুন করি' একমন ।
চৈতন্য-কৃষ্ণের শাস্ত্র যে মত নিরূপণ ॥ ৩১ ॥

sakala vaiṣṇava, śuna kari' eka-mana
all Vaiṣṇavas, hear making one mind
caitanya-kṛṣṇera śāstra ye mata nirūpaṇa
of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa the scriptures as in view establish

31 O Vaiṣṇavas, hear with one-pointed mind how the scriptures establish the truth of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa.[3]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

What the scriptures establish about Kṛṣṇa, who appeared as Caitanya.

The explanation of the fourteen verses above begins. Explanation of the first verse —

কৃষ্ণ, গুরুদ্বয়, ভক্ত, অবতার, প্রকাশ ।
শক্তি, — এই ছয় রূপে করেন বিলাস ॥ ৩২ ॥

kṛṣṇa, gurudvaya, bhakta, avatāra, prakāśa
Kṛṣṇa, the two gurus, devotees, avatāras, manifestations
śakti, — ei chaya rūpe karena vilāsa
potencies — in these six forms He enjoys

32 Kṛṣṇa, the two kinds of guru, the devotees, the avatāras, the manifestations and the potencies — in these six forms He enjoys His pastimes.

Anubhāṣya.

The word *guru-dvaya* (“two gurus”) means the *dīkṣā-guru* and the *śikṣā-guru*. Both are the one, undivided *guru-tattva*. The *dīkṣā-guru* and the *śikṣā-guru* differ in their *līlās*, but for the disciple both are the same truth and deserve the same honour.

এই ছয় তত্ত্বের করি চরণ বন্দন ।
প্রথমে সামান্যে করি মঙ্গলাচরণ ॥ ৩৩ ॥

ei chaya tattvera kari caraṇa vandana
of these six truths I make to the feet worship
prathame sāmānye kari maṅgalācaraṇa
first in general I make the invocation

33 I worship the feet of these six truths; first I make the invocation in general.

বন্দে গুরূনীশভক্তানীশমীশাবতারকান্ ।
তৎপ্রকাশাংশ্চ তচ্চক্তীঃ কৃষ্ণচৈতন্যসংজ্ঞকম্ ॥ ৩৪ ॥

vande gurūn īśa-bhaktān
I worship the gurus, the Lord's devotees
īśam īśāvatārakān
the Lord, the Lord's avatāras
tat-prakāśāṁś ca tac-chaktīḥ
His manifestations and His potencies
kṛṣṇa-caitanya-saṁjñakam
Kṛṣṇa Caitanya named

34 I worship the gurus, the devotees of the Lord, His avatāras, His manifestations and His potencies — and the Lord Himself, who is known as Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I worship the two gurus, distinguished as the *dīkṣā-guru* and the *śikṣā-guru*; the Lord's devotees, Śrīvāsa and others; the Lord's avatāras, Advaita Prabhu and others; the Lord's manifestations, Prabhu Śrī Nityānanda and others; and the Lord's potencies, Śrī Gadādhara and others. And I worship the Supreme Truth, the Lord Himself, named Mahāprabhu Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.

Anubhāṣya.

(**grantha-kāraḥ** (the author of the book, that is, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa)) **gurūn** (the host of gurus, that is, those who show the way, give the mantra and instruct: Śrī Nityānanda, Raghunātha, Rūpa and others) **īśa-bhaktān** (the servants of Gaura-Kṛṣṇa: Śrīvāsa and others) **kṛṣṇa-caitanya-saṁjñakam īśam** (Bhagavān, known as Kṛṣṇa Caitanya) **īśāvatārakān** (Śrī Advaitācārya and others) **tat-prakāśān** (His manifestations, that is, those of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa: Śrī Nityānanda and others, my own gurus) **tac-chaktīḥ** (His potencies, that is, those of Gaura-Kṛṣṇa: Śrī Gadādhara, Dāmodara, Jagadānanda and others) (These six truths are non-different from Him and form His surrounding retinue, His *āvaraṇa*) **vande** ([I] worship).

*Gurus who differ in their *līlās* —*

মন্ত্রগুরু আর যত শিক্ষাগুরুগণ ।
তাঁহার চরণ আগে করিয়ে বন্দন ॥ ৩৫ ॥

mantra-guru āra yata śikṣā-guru-gaṇa
mantra-guru and all instructing gurus
tāṁhāra caraṇa āge kariye vandana
their feet first I make obeisance

35 First I offer obeisance at the feet of my mantra-guru and of all my instructing gurus.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Tāṅhāra ("his"): the singular is used because both kinds of guru are regarded as one truth. A variant reading has *tāṅ-sabāra* ("of them all").

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Jīva Prabhu writes in the *Bhakti-sandarbha* (section 202): "The means to be followed (*abhidheya*) is selfless devotion, *akiñcanā bhakti*. Yet its cause is 'association with My devotees,' so that association is itself the means, and in devotion too one should see that very association. At first a person associates with particular devotees. That association gives rise to a corresponding faith, a taste for the narratives handed down in their line, and so on, and so he turns towards Bhagavān. Through that same association a taste (*ruci*) awakens in him for the particular manifestation of Bhagavān whom those devotees worship, and for their particular path of worship. Then, wishing to know these more fully, he takes one or many of them as his guru and hears from them. * * For those who long for devotion marked by love (*prīti*), the path led by taste is better than the path of reasoning, which guides those in whom taste has not yet awakened. On both paths the former *śravaṇa-guru*, the guru from whom one hears, becomes the *śikṣā-guru* and teaches the rules of worship. But the *mantra-guru* is only one, for accepting many will be forbidden later." (Section 206): "The *śravaṇa-guru* and the *śikṣā-guru* who teaches worship are usually the same person. One should also know that there may be many *śikṣā-gurus*." (Section 208): "Knowledge of the scriptures arises only from association with the *śravaṇa-guru*." (Section 207): "Mercy (*anugraha*) means initiation into the mantra." (Section 209): "Those who reject the guru's feet and try to turn towards Bhagavān grow weary in their various

means. Therefore hundreds of calamities befall them, and they remain here in worldly existence (*saṁsāra*), like those adrift on the ocean without a helmsman." "He is attained through devotion to the guru, and the wise serve Him by remembrance. But even when He is met, living beings absorbed in pride cannot attain Him." (Section 210): "One should take shelter of the guru who guides one to the highest goal, even if one must give up a worldly guru and others to do so."

If selfless devotion is the means, then what one should see in it is association with Kṛṣṇa's devotees. At first the jīva associates with Kṛṣṇa's devotees, gains faith (*śraddhā*) and turns towards Kṛṣṇa. Through that association a taste awakens in him for the particular manifestation of Bhagavān he will serve, and for a particular path of worship. A jīva endowed with pious merit (*sukṛti*) then wishes to know more about Kṛṣṇa. He takes shelter of one or more gurus and hears from them. For those who seek devotion marked by love, the path of taste is commended, not the path of reasoning followed by those in whom taste has not awakened. On both paths the former *śravaṇa-guru* becomes the *śikṣā-guru* and teaches the corresponding rules of worship. The *mantra-guru* is one; accepting many is forbidden. The *śravaṇa-guru* and the guru who teaches worship are usually the same person, while *śikṣā-gurus* may be many. And knowledge of the scriptures comes only from association with the *śravaṇa-guru*. Initiation into the mantra is itself the mercy (*anugraha*). Those who disregard the guru's lotus feet and seek nearness to Bhagavān grow weary in their various means. So hundreds upon hundreds of calamities fall upon the living being who lacks devotion to the guru. He bears the name of a devotee, yet the calamities keep him only in worldly existence. Like a boat on the ocean without a helmsman, he finds no deliverance from it. Kṛṣṇa is attained only by serving the guru. Devotees serve Him by remembrance and other practices. Someone may think, "I already understand more — what more could another guru teach me?" Such pride is an offence, and because of it one cannot attain devotion to Kṛṣṇa. One should take shelter not of an unworthy pretender (*gurubruva*) — a worldly, conventional or hereditary guru — but of the *pāramārthika-guru*, who guides one to the highest goal.

*The author's *śikṣā-gurus* —*

শ্রীরূপ, সনাতন, ভট্ট রঘুনাথ।
শ্রীজীব, গোপালভট্ট, দাস রঘুনাথ ॥ ৩৬ ॥

śrī-rūpa, sanātana, bhaṭṭa raghunātha
Śrī Rūpa, Sanātana, Bhaṭṭa Raghunātha
śrī-jīva, gopāla-bhaṭṭa, dāsa raghunātha
Śrī Jīva, Gopāla Bhaṭṭa, Dāsa Raghunātha

36 Śrī Rūpa, Sanātana, Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa, Śrī Jīva, Gopāla Bhaṭṭa and Raghunātha Dāsa —

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Rūpa, Śrī Sanātana and Śrī Jīva — see Ādi 10.85. Śrī Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa — see Ādi 10.153–158. Śrī Raghunātha Dāsa — see Ādi 10.91. Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa — see Ādi 10.105.

এই ছয় গুরু — শিক্ষাগুরু যে আমার ।
তাঁ' সবার পাদপদ্মে কোটি নমস্কার ॥ ৩৭ ॥

ei chaya guru — śikṣā-guru ye āmāra
these six gurus — instructing gurus who are mine
tāṁ' sabāra pāda-padme koṭi namaskāra
of all of them at the lotus feet ten million obeisances

37 these six are my instructing gurus; at the lotus feet of them all I offer millions of obeisances.

*The Lord's devotee (*īśa-bhakta*) —*
ভগবানের ভক্ত যত শ্রীবাস প্রধান ।
তাঁহার চরণপদ্মে সহস্র প্রণাম ॥ ৩৮ ॥

bhagavānera bhakta yata śrīvāsa pradhāna
of the Lord devotees all Śrīvāsa the chief
tāṁhāra caraṇa-padme sahasra praṇāma
their at the lotus feet a thousand obeisances

38 To all the devotees of the Lord, of whom Śrīvāsa is the chief, I offer thousands of obeisances at their lotus feet.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrīvāsa — see Ādi 10.8.

*The Lord's avatāra (*īśāvatāra*) —*

অদ্বৈত আচার্য্য — প্রভুর অংশ-অবতার ।
তাঁর পাদপদ্মে কোটি প্রণতি আমার ॥ ৩৯ ॥

advaita ācārya — prabhura aṁśa-avatāra
Advaita Ācārya — of the Lord partial avatāra
tāṁra pāda-padme koṭi praṇati āmāra
at His lotus feet ten million obeisances mine

39 Advaita Ācārya is a partial avatāra of the Lord; at His lotus feet I offer millions of obeisances.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Advaita — see Ādi, Chapter 6.

*The Lord's manifestation (*īśa-prakāśa*) —*

নিত্যানন্দরায় — প্রভুর স্বরূপপ্রকাশ ।
তাঁর পাদপদ্ম বন্দো যাঁর মুঞি দাস ॥ ৪০ ॥

nityānanda-rāya — prabhura svarūpa-prakāśa
Nityānanda Rāya — of the Lord own-form manifestation
tāṁra pāda-padma vando yāṁra muñi dāsa
His lotus feet I worship whose I servant

40 Śrī Nityānanda Rāya is the Lord's own direct manifestation (*svarūpa-prakāśa*). I worship His lotus feet: I am His servant.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Nityānanda — see Ādi, Chapter 5.

*The Lord's potency (*īśa-śakti*) —*

গদাধর পণ্ডিতাদি — প্রভুর নিজশক্তি ।
তাঁ-সবার চরণে মোর সহস্র প্রণতি ॥ ৪১ ॥

gadādhara paṇḍitādi — prabhura nija-śakti
Gadādhara Paṇḍita and others — of the Lord own potencies
tāṁ-sabāra caraṇe mora sahasra praṇati
of all of them at the feet my thousand obeisances

41 Gadādhara Paṇḍita and the others are the Lord's own potencies; at the feet of them all I offer thousands of obeisances.

*The Lord Himself (*īśa-tattva*) —*

শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য প্রভু স্বয়ং ভগবান্ ।
তাঁহার পদারবিন্দে অনন্ত প্রণাম ॥ ৪২ ॥

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu svayaṁ bhagavān
Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Prabhu Himself Bhagavān
tāṁhāra padāravinde ananta praṇāma
His at the lotus feet endless obeisances

42 Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is Bhagavān Himself; at His lotus feet I offer endless obeisances.

সাবরণে প্রভুরে করিয়া নমস্কার ।
এই ছয় তেঁহো যৈছে — করিয়ে বিচার ॥ ৪৩ ॥

sāvaraṇe prabhure kariyā namaskāra
with His entourage to the Lord having made obeisance
ei chaya teṁho yaiche — kariye vicāra
these six He how — I make consideration

43 Having bowed to the Lord together with His entourage, I shall now consider how He Himself is these six.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Āvaraṇa, the surrounding retinue: the devotees who surround the Lord on every side are His *āvaraṇa*. I have bowed to Him together with this retinue. The six truths — the guru, the Lord's devotee, the Lord's avatāra, the Lord's manifestation, the Lord's potency, and the Lord Himself, Kṛṣṇa Caitanya — are His own *svarūpa*. Now I shall consider how this is so.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Gaurasundara receives endless obeisances, Śrī Advaita and the *śikṣā-gurus* millions, and the truths of potency and of the devotees thousands. This difference in the number of obeisances does not imply a worldly notion of difference born of māyā.

Kṛṣṇa Caitanyadeva displays Himself (*vilāsa*) in exactly these six forms of truth: the two gurus, the Lord's devotee, the Lord, the avatāra, the manifestation and the potency. By the principle of *acintya-bhedābheda*, this nondual Knowledge (*advaya-jñāna*) is called by the name "Kṛṣṇa Caitanya."

যদ্যপি আমার গুরু — চৈতন্যের দাস ।
তথাপি জানিয়ে আমি তাঁহার প্রকাশ ॥ ৪৪ ॥

yadyapi āmāra guru — caitanyera dāsa
although my guru — of Caitanya a servant
tathāpi jāniye āmi tāṁhāra prakāśa
still know I His manifestation

44 Although my Guru is a servant of Śrī Caitanya, I know him to be His manifestation.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
All jīvas are servants of Kṛṣṇa, so my guru too is in truth Kṛṣṇa's servant. Even so, I shall know my guru as Kṛṣṇa's manifestation (*prakāśa*). For the disciple, the guru is the very form of Kṛṣṇa's manifestation. But Nityānanda, who is Baladeva, is in truth *prakāśa-tattva* whose nature is *vilāsa*.

*The truth of the guru. (1) The *dīkṣā-guru* —*

গুরু কৃষ্ণরূপ হন শাস্ত্রের প্রমাণে ।
গুরুরূপে কৃষ্ণ কৃপা করেন ভক্তগণে ॥ ৪৫ ॥

guru kṛṣṇa-rūpa hana śāstrera pramāṇe
the guru Kṛṣṇa's form is of scripture by the evidence
guru-rūpe kṛṣṇa kṛpā karena bhakta-gaṇe
in the form of the guru Kṛṣṇa mercy shows to the devotees

45 On the evidence of scripture the guru is a form of Kṛṣṇa: in the form of the guru, Kṛṣṇa bestows His mercy on the devotees.

Anubhāṣya.

Everyone except Mahāprabhu Caitanyadeva is His servant. So in the guru no manifestation is possible other than service to Caitanya. He is a servant because he is the *āśraya-vigraha*, the form who shelters and holds love. The guru is a form in which service is manifest, and he appears in no other way than in service to the One who is served. The guru is the very form of a manifestation (*prakāśa*), and there is no room to regard him as the *viṣaya-vigraha*, the object of love. It is as the *āśraya-vigraha* that the scriptures call him a form of Kṛṣṇa.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.17.27)*

আচার্য্যং মাং বিজানীয়ান্নাবমন্যেত কর্হিচিৎ ।
ন মর্ত্ত্যবুদ্ধ্যাসূয়েত সর্ব্বদেবময়ো গুরুঃ ॥ ৪৬ ॥

ācāryaṁ māṁ vijānīyān
the ācārya Me one should know
nāvamanyeta karhicit
one should not disrespect ever
na martya-buddhyāsūyeta
not as a mortal should envy
sarva-deva-mayo guruḥ
of all gods composed the guru

46 "Know the ācārya to be Me. Never show him disrespect, and do not envy him, thinking him an ordinary mortal, for the Guru embodies all the gods." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.17.27)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Bhagavān said to Uddhava: "O Uddhava, know the guru to be My very self. Do not regard the guru with *asūyā*, that is, with disrespect, thinking him an ordinary man. The guru embodies all the gods."

Anubhāṣya.

Uddhava heard about *svadharma*, one's true duty, both for those who follow *varṇāśrama* and for others; its defining mark is devotion to Kṛṣṇa. He then asked

Bhagavān how to practise this devotion. The Lord describes the nature of each *varṇa*. Speaking of the *brahmacārī*'s life in the guru's house, He tells how one should behave towards the guru:

ācāryam (the guru) **mām** (as My dearest one) **vijānīyāt** (one should know) **karhicit** (ever) **na avamanyeta** (one should not reproach, even if there is a reason) **guruḥ sarva-deva-mayaḥ** ([for] the guru embodies all the gods) **martya-buddhyā** ([him] with an intellect bound by conditioned, material place, time and person) **na asūyeta** (one should not, growing envious through one's own material dullness, think him equal to oneself).

Ācārya: "The twice-born who performs the *upanayana* rite for a disciple and teaches him the Veda with its rituals and secret portions is called an ācārya." (*Manu-saṁhitā* 2.140). "He who gathers the meaning of the scriptures, establishes others in right conduct and himself acts accordingly is called an ācārya." (*Vāyu Purāṇa*).

Śrī Bhagavān Himself appears before the disciple in the form of the ācārya. In the conduct of the revered ācārya there is nothing but service to Hari. He is the *āśraya-vigraha* in person. If someone has turned away from serving Hari yet fancies himself an ācārya, no one will take his bad conduct for good. The ācārya's undivided worship is what shows him to be a manifestation of Bhagavān. Those devoted to their senses and unsatisfied in enjoyment envy even the ācārya's faultless conduct. The ācārya is a limb inseparable from Bhagavān, the One who is served. Therefore a jīva who harbours hostility towards him loses the mercy of Bhagavān and His associates and falls into misfortune.

The guru is in truth a servant of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. Yet the disciple looks with transcendental vision and will know him as a special manifestation of Śrī Gaurasundara. This does not mean that the guru in fact lacks the eternal relationship of a servant with Kṛṣṇa, the One he serves, or that he differs in no way from Vrajendranandana in the variety of *līlā*. The impersonalists (*nirviśeṣa-vādīs*) hold that transcendental realisation contains no distinctions — neither internal ones, nor those among things of one kind, nor those among things of different kinds. But no Vaiṣṇava ācārya endowed with devotion follows their view or says that there is no difference whatever between the guru and Kṛṣṇa. He teaches *acintya-bhedābheda-tattva*. Śrī Raghunātha Dāsa Gosvāmī Prabhu says of the guru: "Remember the best of gurus as most dear to Mukunda." Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī Prabhu wrote in the *Bhakti-sandarbha* (section 213): "Pure devotees see Śrī Guru

and Śrī Śiva as non-different from Bhagavān only in the sense that they are supremely dear to Him." Following him, Śrī Viśvanātha Cakravartī Ṭhākura said in his hymn to Śrī Gurudeva: "All the scriptures call him Hari Himself, and the virtuous regard him so; yet he is the Lord's dear servant. I worship the lotus feet of such a guru." That is, all the scriptures say that for the disciple the guru is "Hari," and the sādhus know the guru as such. But the guru, eternally the very form of a manifestation, has the right to the dear service of Kṛṣṇa Caitanyadeva. I, the guru's eternal servant, worship the lotus feet of such a guru. Every Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇava meditates on the guru, knowing Śrī Gurudeva, the *āśraya-vigraha*, as *tadīya*, "His own." In all the ancient systems of worship and in the songs of pure devotion, Śrī Gurudeva is named a dear friend of Śrī Rādhā or a manifestation of Śrī Nityānanda's own form.

*(2) The truth of the *śikṣā-guru*; his two forms: (a) the *caitya-guru* (the guru within the heart), (b) the *mahānta-guru* —*

শিক্ষাগুরুকে ত' জানি কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপ ।
অন্তর্য্যামী, ভক্তশ্রেষ্ঠ — এই দুই রূপ ॥ ৪৭ ॥

śikṣā-guruke ta' jāni kṛṣṇera svarūpa
the instructing guru indeed I know Kṛṣṇa's own form
antaryāmī, bhakta-śreṣṭha — ei dui rūpa
the Indweller, the best of devotees — these two forms

47 I know the instructing Guru to be Kṛṣṇa's own form, in two aspects: the Indweller within, and the best of devotees.

Anubhāṣya.

He who teaches worship (*bhajana*) is the *śikṣā-guru*. One who is without worship and of bad conduct is neither a guru nor an ācārya. Teachers are of two kinds: the *mahānta-guru*, who delights in worship, and the *caitya-guru*, who grants the discernment favourable to worship. Instruction in worship differs according to the goal (*sādhya*) and the practice. Śrī Gurudeva, who gives Kṛṣṇa, enriches the disciple with knowledge of *sambandha* and awakens in him a realisation of his own service. The disciple receives the mercy of this *dīkṣā-guru* and learns to serve Viṣṇu properly. This instruction is called *abhidheya*. The *śikṣā-guru* is the *āśraya-vigraha* who embodies *abhidheya*. So he is not different from the *dīkṣā-guru*, who gives knowledge of *sambandha*. Both are Śrī Gurudeva. To

treat one of them as higher and the other as lower, outwardly or at heart, brings offence. As words, Kṛṣṇa's "*rūpa*" (form) and "*svarūpa*" do not differ. The *dīkṣā-guru* Śrī Sanātana gives the lotus feet of Madana-mohana. The jīva has forgotten Bhagavān and cannot wander in Vraja. Sanātana gives him the realisation that Bhagavān's feet are all his wealth. The *śikṣā-guru* Śrī Rūpa gives the right to serve the feet of Śrī Govinda and His dearest ones.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.29.6)*

নৈবোপয়ন্ত্যপচিতিং কবয়স্তবেশ
ব্রহ্মায়ুষাপি কৃতমৃদ্ধমুদঃ স্মরন্তঃ ৷
যোঽন্তর্বহির্তনুভৃতামশুভং বিধুন্ব-
ন্নাচার্য্য-চৈত্ত্যবপুষা স্বগতিং ব্যনক্তি ॥ ৪৮ ॥

naivopayanty apacitiṁ kavayas taveśa
not attain repayment the wise Your, O Lord
brahmāyuṣāpi kṛtam ṛddha-mudaḥ smarantaḥ
with Brahmā's lifespan even Your deeds with growing joy remembering
yo 'ntar bahis tanu-bhṛtām aśubhaṁ vidhunvann
who within without of the embodied the inauspicious dispelling
ācārya-caitya-vapuṣā sva-gatiṁ vyanakti
as ācārya and Supersoul in forms Your own path reveal

48 "O Lord! Even if the wise lived as long as Brahmā and remembered with ever-growing joy all that You have done for them, they could not repay their debt to You. For, dispelling all that is inauspicious in embodied souls, You come to them from without as the ācārya and from within as the Supersoul, and reveal to them the way to Yourself." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.29.6)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Lord! The wise are filled with bliss when they remember You, yet even with a lifespan like Brahmā's they could not repay You. For in Your boundless mercy You abide outside as the ācārya and within as the indwelling Lord (*antaryāmī*). You do this to destroy all that is inauspicious in embodied souls and to reveal to them their own path.

Anubhāṣya.

Uddhava had heard the scripture of yoga in detail and saw that the path of yoga is very difficult. He wishes to hear from Bhagavān briefly about *bhakti-yoga*, and he says to Him:

īśa (O Lord) **tava kṛtam** (the kindness You have done) **smarantaḥ** (thinking of it) **ṛddha-mudaḥ** (those whose supreme bliss has grown) **kavayaḥ** (the discerning) **brahmāyuṣā api** (even with a lifespan equal to Brahmā's, spent worshipping You) **apacitim** (repayment, that is, discharge of the debt) **naiva upayanti** (do not attain) **yaḥ** ([for] You) **bahiḥ ācārya-vapuṣā** (outwardly in the form of the ācārya, that is, as the *mantra-guru* or the *śikṣā-guru*) **antaḥ caitya-vapuṣā** (inwardly in the form of the indwelling Lord [*antaryāmī*]) **tanubhṛtām** (of embodied living beings) **aśubham** (what is inauspicious, that is, absorption in objects other than Kṛṣṇa) **vidhunvan** (dispelling) **sva-gatim** (their own path, that is, their true nature, marked by being the Lord's associate) **vyanakti** (You reveal).

*Śrī Bhagavān grants the perfection of love to the surrendered practitioner — (*Bhagavad-gītā* 10.10)*

তেষাং সততযুক্তানাং ভজতাং প্রীতিপূর্ব্বকম্ ।
দদামি বুদ্ধিযোগং তং যেন মামুপয়ান্তি তে ॥ ৪৯ ॥

teṣāṁ satata-yuktānāṁ
to them ever longing (for Me)
bhajatāṁ prīti-pūrvakam
worshipping with love
dadāmi buddhi-yogaṁ taṁ
I give understanding that
yena mām upayānti te
by which to Me come they

49 "To those who are ever devoted to Me and worship Me with love, I give the understanding that brings them to Me." (Bhagavad-gītā, 10.10)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"To those who worship Me with love through eternal *bhakti-yoga*, I give the pure *prema-yoga* born of pure knowledge. Through it they reach My abode of supreme bliss."

Anubhāṣya.

There are wise devotees (*paṇḍitas*) who know that everything arises and acts from Bhagavān. They are fixed in unwavering *bhakti-yoga* and worship Him; their minds are turned to Kṛṣṇa, and Kṛṣṇa is their life. They share their feelings with one another and speak about Hari; so they please Kṛṣṇa and delight in Him. Of them Kṛṣṇa says to Arjuna:

teṣām satata-yuktānām (of those who always long to be joined with Me in service) **prīti-pūrvakam** (with love, with reverence) **bhajatām** (who serve: those who have given up other desires, karma and jñāna and are devoted to serving Hari) **tam buddhi-yogam dadāmi** (I give that *buddhi-yoga*, that is, I Myself awaken it in the movements of their hearts) **yena te mām upayānti** (by which they attain Me).

(The sense: this *buddhi-yoga* cannot be gained by oneself or from anyone else; I alone can give it, and only they, such devotees, can receive it.)

যথা ভগবান্ ব্রহ্মণে স্বয়মুপদিশ্যানুভাবিতবান্ ॥ ৫০ ॥

yathā bhagavān brahmaṇe
as the Lord to Brahmā

svayam upadiśyānubhāvitavān
Himself having instructed made him realise

50 "Thus the Lord Himself instructed Brahmā and made him realise it."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Bhagavān Himself made Brahmā realise this by instructing him as follows.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.9.30–35)*

জ্ঞানং পরমগুহ্যং মে যদ্বিজ্ঞান-সমন্বিতম্ ।
সরহস্যং তদঙ্গঞ্চ গৃহাণ গদিতং ময়া ॥ ৫১ ॥

jñānaṁ parama-guhyaṁ me
knowledge most confidential of Me
yad vijñāna-samanvitam
which with realisation endowed
sa-rahasyaṁ tad-aṅgaṁ ca
with its secret and its limb also
gṛhāṇa gaditaṁ mayā
receive spoken by Me

51 "Receive from Me, as I speak it, the supremely confidential knowledge of Myself, endowed with realisation, together with its secret and that secret's integral part." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.9.31)[4]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Out of mercy I am telling you My supreme secret knowledge, filled with realisation (*vijñāna*), together with its mystery and its parts. Accept it.

Anubhāṣya.

Brahmā resolved to create and sank into deep thought. He heard a divine voice say "*Tapa*" (austerity), and he gave himself sincerely to austerity. Viṣṇu became pleased with him, and Brahmā beheld Vaikuṇṭha. There he was freed from pride and began to inquire about the truth, and Bhagavān spoke six verses. See the *Gauḍīya-bhāṣya* on the *Bhāgavatam*, pp. 577–629.

me (My, that is, Bhagavān's) **jñānam parama-guhyam** (knowledge that surpasses even knowledge of the impersonal Brahman and the like) **vijñāna-samanvitam** (joined with realisation [*vijñāna*]. I give you not merely knowledge of My form, but knowledge joined with *vijñāna*, the realisation of Kṛṣṇa and of all that belongs to Kṛṣṇa) **sa-rahasyam** (with its mystery. If there is anything secret in it, that comes too, namely *prema-bhakti*) **tad-aṅgam ca** (and with its limb: *sādhana-bhakti-yoga*, which consists of hearing and the rest and aids knowledge of *sambandha*) **mayā gaditam** (spoken by Me. You did not ask about these three, yet I speak of them out of mercy, and no one else has spoken of them) **sat gṛhāṇa** (accept).

যাবানহং যথাভাবো যদ্রূপগুণকর্ম্মকঃ ।
তথৈব তত্ত্ববিজ্ঞানমস্তু তে মদনুগ্রহাৎ ॥ ৫২ ॥

yāvān ahaṁ yathā-bhāvo
as great as I am, in what being
yad-rūpa-guṇa-karmakaḥ
with what forms qualities and deeds
tathaiva tattva-vijñānam
just so the true realisation
astu te mad-anugrahāt
may be yours by My grace

52 "By My grace may you truly realise Me as I am — My being, My forms, My qualities and My deeds." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.9.32)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
By My mercy, realise the full truth of what My own nature (*svarūpa*) is, and what My characteristics, form, qualities and *līlās* are.

Anubhāṣya.
yāvān (of what size and shape. That is, what My form is like, its limbs joined in a particular harmony of fullness, slenderness, length, height and the rest, and what My measure is in My own nature) **aham yathā-bhāvaḥ** (what My being is, what My characteristics are) **aham yad-rūpa-guṇa-karmakaḥ** (He who has these forms, qualities and deeds. The forms are the dark, the four-armed, the two-armed and the golden, the form of Kṛṣṇa, of Rāma, of Nṛsiṁha and others. The qualities are love for the devotees and others. The deeds are accepting Lakṣmī, lifting Govardhana and others) **tathaiva** (just so, in every respect) **tattva-vijñānam** (realisation of their truth) **mad-anugrahāt** (by My mercy) **te** (to you) **astu** (may it be).

(As *sādhana-bhakti* and prema-bhakti grow in you, you will realise ever more of the sweetness of My form, qualities and *līlās*. So you will directly realise Me in the land of Vraja — Kṛṣṇa, supremely hard to attain, whose sweetness surpasses even My own form.) (This by itself refutes the view that the four verses point to the impersonal.)

অহমেবাসমেবাগ্রে নান্যৎ যৎ সদসৎপরম্ ।
পশ্চাদহং যদেতচ্চ যোঽবশিষ্যেত সোঽস্ম্যহম্ ॥ ৫৩ ॥

aham evāsam evāgre
I alone was indeed before (creation)
nānyat yat sad-asat-param
nothing else which effect cause beyond
paścād ahaṁ yad etac ca
afterwards I what this (world) also
yo 'vaśiṣyeta so 'smy aham
what remains that am I

53 "Before creation I alone existed; there was nothing else — neither effect, nor cause, nor That which is beyond them. After creation this whole world is not other than Me, and what remains after its dissolution is also I." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.9.33)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Before this world was created, I alone existed. Nothing existed apart from Me — neither *sat* nor *asat*, nor even the indescribable Brahman without attributes (*nirviśeṣa*). After creation I exist as all this, and when creation dissolves, I alone shall remain."

Anubhāṣya.

aham (the word *aham* ["I"] denotes the speaker, the one who has form, not the impersonal Brahman, for that cannot be its object. If knowledge of the self [*ātmā*] were meant, then, as in *tat tvam asi* ["you are that"], it would have been proper to say *tvam eva asīḥ* ["you alone were"]. I am that most enchanting divine form [*śrī-vigraha*] who now appears before you) **eva agre** (before creation, even at the time of the great dissolution) **āsam** (I was) **anyat na** (nothing else was. So say the Śrutis: "Vāsudeva alone was, neither Brahmā nor Śaṅkara," "Nārāyaṇa alone was, neither Brahmā nor Īśāna," and so on. Vaikuṇṭha, His associates and the rest are His inseparable part, so the same word *aham* includes them, just as the phrase "the king is setting out" includes his retinue.[11]) **sad-asat-param** (beyond *sat* and *asat*. *Sat* is the effect, *asat* the cause) **yat** (that, that is, Brahman) **tat anyat na** (is not other than Me. Or else: at that time, since there was no variety in the cosmos, I was in the form of pure, attributeless spirit, and in Vaikuṇṭha in the form of Bhagavān with attributes) **paścāt** (and after creation) **aham** (I alone am: in Vaikuṇṭha as Bhagavān and other forms, in the worlds as the indwelling Lord and other forms) **yad etat** (this universe) **tat api aham eva**

asmi (that too is only I, for the universe is not other than Me and is Mine by nature) **yo 'vaśiṣyeta so 'ham eva asmi** ([and at dissolution] what remains is I).

(The sense: the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's eternal *līlās* is not limited by time and the like, and He is manifest at all times.)

ঋতেঽর্থং যৎ প্রতীয়েত ন প্রতীয়েত চাত্মনি ।
তদ্বিদ্যাদাত্মনো মায়াং যথাভাসো যথা তমঃ ॥ ৫৪ ॥

ṛte 'rtham yat pratīyeta
without the reality what may appear
na pratīyeta cātmani
not may appear and in Me
tad vidyād ātmano māyām
that one should know My māyā
yathābhāso yathā tamaḥ
as the reflection as the darkness

54 "Whatever appears to exist apart from Me, the Reality, and does not appear in Me, know that to be My māyā, like a reflection and like darkness." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.9.34)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The previous verse established knowledge of the nature (*svarūpa*) of the Supreme Truth. But there is no realisation (*vijñāna*) until that knowledge of the *svarūpa-tattva* is made firm by knowing the truth that is other than the *svarūpa*. The truth other than the *svarūpa-tattva* is called *māyā*. This verse sets out knowledge of the *māyā-tattva* in detail. The *svarūpa-tattva* is the *artha*, that is, the true reality. Whatever is perceived outside that truth, and whatever has no place in the perception of the *svarūpa-tattva* itself, should be known as a manifestation of māyā (*māyā-vaibhava*) belonging to the *ātma-tattva*. Since this is not easy to grasp, here are two particular examples. Think of the *svarūpa-tattva* as the sun. What is other than the sun is perceived in two forms: as *ābhāsa*, a reflection, and as *tamas*, darkness. The sun's reflection falls from water onto another place; this is called *ābhāsa*. The side where the sun's power is not seen is called *tamas*, that is, darkness. The spiritual world is the rays of Bhagavān's own form. The manifestation of māyā is an *ābhāsa* that rests on its likeness to that world; this is the example of *ābhāsa*. The darkness far removed

from the spiritual truth (*cit-tattva*) is that same manifestation of māyā; this is the second example. The point is this: the *ātma-tattva* and the *māyā-tattva* stand in a twofold relation. First, whatever is manifest as a form other than the *ātma-svarūpa* is *māyā*. And the ignorance, the non-self far removed from the *ātma-svarūpa*, is also māyā.

Anubhāṣya.

artham (the highest reality) **mām ṛte** (without Me) **yat pratīyeta** (what is perceived. When I am perceived it is not perceived, so it is perceived only outside Me) **yac ca ātmani na pratīyeta** (and what is not perceived without resting on Me, that is, is not perceived by itself) **tat** (a thing with these marks) **ātmanaḥ** (of Me, the Supreme Lord) **yathābhāsaḥ** (like *ābhāsa*, a reflection. *Ābhāsa* is a particular reflection of a luminary, somehow cast onto a place beyond its own light. It is perceived only outside the luminary, yet without the luminary it cannot be perceived at all) **yathā tamaḥ** (like darkness. Here the word *tamas* means a play of colours close to darkness. It does not exist in the light that is its source, yet it cannot exist without resting on that light) **māyām** (so too this potency called *māyā*, which is twofold: *jīva-māyā* and *guṇa-māyā*) **vidyāt** (one should know).

যথা মহান্তি ভূতানি ভূতেষূচ্চাবচেষ্বনু ।
প্রবিষ্টান্যপ্রবিষ্টানি তথা তেষু ন তেষ্বহম্ ॥ ৫৫ ॥

yathā mahānti bhūtāni
as the great elements
bhūteṣūccāvaceṣv anu
in beings great and small after
praviṣṭāny apraviṣṭāni
entered not entered
tathā teṣu na teṣv aham
so in them not in them I

55 “As the great elements enter all beings, great and small, and yet remain outside them, so I am within all that is created and yet beyond it.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.9.35)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The great elements enter beings large and small, yet they also remain independent, as if they had not entered. In the same way I, as the Supersoul (*Paramātmā*), the

shelter of their existence, enter all beings in this world of elements, and yet I eternally abide apart in My form as Bhagavān. For the devotees I am the only object of love. The meaning is this. The great elements — earth, water, fire, air and ether — combine and manifest the gross world. They are present within it as its components, yet in their state as great elements they remain independent. In the same way the spiritual Supreme Lord creates the world through His material potency and His potency of the jīvas. With one portion of Himself He pervades the world, yet at the same time He eternally abides in His spiritual abode in the fullness of His spiritual form. And the jīvas, the tiniest particles of the rays of His spiritual form, taste pure love for Him on the path of pure love. This is the secret.

Anubhāṣya.

yathā mahānti bhūtāni (as the great elements, ether and the rest) **uccāvaceṣu bhūteṣu** (in higher and lower beings: gods, humans, animals and others) **apraviṣṭāni** (though situated outside) **anupraviṣṭāni** (appear to be within) **tathā** (so too [though I have not entered, for I abide in Vaikuṇṭha, beyond the worlds]) **aham teṣu** (I, in those renowned for the corresponding qualities) **nateṣu** (in those who bow down to Me) **praviṣṭaḥ** (have entered: I abide in the heart to show Myself to their inner sight).

In the same way, without entering, I also abide outside. I do this to give their eyes My beauty and their nostrils My fragrance; to converse with them and fill their ears with the nectar of My sweet voice; and by touch, embrace and the like to let their bodies feel the tenderness, sweetness and other graces of My body. These devotees are beyond the *guṇas*, and I cannot leave them, either within or without: My play with them is always full of attachment. This shows that the “mystery” is their prema-bhakti, which brings Me so under their control.

এতাবদেব জিজ্ঞাস্যং তত্ত্বজিজ্ঞাসুনাত্মনঃ ।
অন্বয়-ব্যতিরেকাভ্যাং যৎ স্যাৎ সর্ব্বত্র সর্ব্বদা ॥ ৫৬ ॥

etāvad eva jijñāsyaṁ
so much indeed to be inquired
tattva-jijñāsunātmanaḥ
by one seeking the truth of the Self
anvaya-vyatirekābhyāṁ
positively and negatively
yat syāt sarvatra sarvadā
which may be everywhere always

56 "This much must be inquired into by one who seeks the truth of the Self: That which exists everywhere and always, both directly and indirectly." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.9.36)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
One who seeks knowledge of the *ātma-tattva* should examine this subject by *anvaya-vyatireka*, the direct and the indirect method, and search for the reality that is eternal everywhere and always. The point is this: the means by which the secret of love is attained is called *sādhana-bhakti*. The seeker of truth learns *anvaya-vyatireka*, that is, injunctions and prohibitions, at the feet of a true guru. Cultivating the truth constantly in this way, he will attain knowledge of the truth.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* contains the teaching of Mahāprabhu Śrī Caitanyadeva in full. The *Bhāgavatam* has 18,000 verses.

The root of everything in those eighteen thousand verses lies in these four. The verse *aham eva* briefly describes the truth of Bhagavān, His own form, His qualities and His *līlās*. The verse *ṛte 'rtham* examines the truths of māyā, of the jīva and of matter. *Māyā-tattva* appears separately from Bhagavān's *svarūpa-tattva*. *Jīva-tattva*, through its connection with this *māyā-tattva*, is liable to fall under the control of the māyā potency. *Jaḍa-tattva*, matter, is the field of the jīva's enjoyment. From these two verses one should fully grasp knowledge of *sambandha*. The verse *yathā mahānti* says that Bhagavān's eternal form abides separately, although the truth of Bhagavān is inconceivably one with the jīvas and matter and different from them. It also names the supreme goal (*prayojana*): the jīvas take shelter at His feet and gain the wealth of great love, *mahā-prema*. The verse *etāvad eva* names the only means to reach this supreme goal: *sādhana-bhakti*. *Sādhana-bhakti* includes injunctions that lead to the goal; as favourable, they are called *anvaya*. Actions that obstruct the goal and produce what is un-

favourable are counted among the prohibitions and called *vyatireka*. The truth of practice is called *abhidheya*. *Abhidheya* is the instruction one receives through the direct meaning of the scriptures (*abhidhā-vṛtti*).

Anubhāṣya.

ātmanaḥ (of Me, Bhagavān) **tattva-jijñāsunā** (by one who wishes to realise what truly brings about his good) **etāvad eva jijñāsyam** (this alone should be learned at the feet of Śrī Guru).

(What is it?)

yat (that one reality which…) **anvaya-vyatirekābhyām** (through injunctions and prohibitions…) **sarvadā sarvatra syāt** (exists always and everywhere).

(If one asks which of heaven, liberation and prema is one's own good, the answer is: prema is established by its own *anvaya* and *vyatireka*, whereas heaven and liberation are not established by them.) (That is: of all that is to be learned, this alone should be learned. What is it?)

anvaya-vyatirekābhyām (through union and separation, that is, through *sambhoga* and *vipralambha*) **yat syāt sarvatra** (what exists everywhere: in Śrī Vṛndāvana and the other abodes beyond all the universes — in the servants, friends, elders and beloveds) **sarvadā** (eternally, even at the time of the great dissolution).

(This points to the relishing of the four *rasas* of servitude, friendship, parental love and amorous love: *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *śṛṅgāra*.)

*(In the first verse of the *Śrī Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta*) —*

চিন্তামণির্জয়তি সোমগিরির্গুরুর্মে
শিক্ষাগুরুশ্চ ভগবান্ শিখিপিঞ্ছমৌলিঃ ।
যৎপাদকল্পতরুপল্লবশেখরেষু
লীলাস্বয়ম্বররসং লভতে জয়শ্রীঃ ॥ ৫৭ ॥

cintāmaṇir jayati somagirir gurur me
Cintāmaṇi glory Somagiri guru my
śikṣā-guruś ca bhagavān śikhi-piñcha-mauliḥ
instructing guru and the Lord with peacock feather crowned
yat-pāda-kalpataru-pallava-śekhareṣu
whose feet wish-tree sprouts at the tips
līlā-svayaṁvara-rasaṁ labhate jayaśrīḥ
in pastime self-choice the rasa attains Jayaśrī

57 "Glory to Cintāmaṇi and to Somagiri, my guru! Glory to my instructing guru, the Lord whose crown is a peacock feather! At the tips of His feet, like the tender shoots of a wish-fulfilling tree, Jayaśrī (Śrī Rādhā) tastes the joy of choosing Him as Her own." (Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta, 1)[5]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Glory to my guru named Somagiri, who is like a wish-fulfilling gem (*cintāmaṇi*)![10] Glory also to my *śikṣā-guru*, Bhagavān, who wears a peacock feather! Jayaśrī, that is, Śrīmatī Rādhikā, tastes the joy of *svayaṁvara*, the free choice of a husband: she is drawn by the beauty of His toenail tips, on feet that are like shoots of the wish-fulfilling tree.

Anubhāṣya.

The book *Śrī Vallabha-digvijaya* places the time of Śrī Bilvamaṅgala — a Draviḍian king of ascetics, a *tridaṇḍī* — in the eighth century of the Śaka era. Bilvamaṅgala is mentioned as the chief disciple of Rāja-Viṣṇusvāmī, who installed the Deity of Dvārakādhīśa. Bilvamaṅgala's disciples were Devamaṅgala and others. Bilvamaṅgala worshipped for seven hundred years in Vṛndāvana at Brahmakuṇḍa. After his meeting with Vallabha Bhaṭṭa, the worship of his Deity was entrusted to Hari Brahmacārī. Bilvamaṅgala's name also appears in the list of the Dvārakā *maṭha* of Śaṅkara's sampradāya: "Citsukhācārya (Kali era 2715), Bilvamaṅgala." Līlāśuka Śrī Bilvamaṅgala Ṭhākura longed to enter the transcendental *līlās* of Vṛndāvana. At the beginning of his song *Śrī Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta* he glorifies three kinds of guru:

me (my) **guruḥ** (the *śravaṇa-guru*, who shows the way) **cintāmaṇiḥ jayati** (Cintāmaṇi — may this guru be glorified) **somagiriḥ** ([the *mantra-guru*] Somagiri [may he be glorified]) **śikṣā-guruḥ śikhi-piñcha-mauliḥ** ([the *caitya*] *śikṣā-guru*, He whose crown ornament is a peacock feather) **bhagavān**

(Vṛndāvana-candra [may He be glorified]) **yat-pāda-kalpa-taru-pallava-śekhareṣu** (at the toenail tips on His feet, which are shoots of the wish-fulfilling tree) **jaya-śrīḥ** (She who is both Jayā and Śrī, that is, Mahālakṣmī, the Queen of Vṛndāvana) **līlā-svayam-vara-rasam** (the sweetness, the joy, of a *svayaṁvara* [free choice] enacted in play, with deep *anurāga*) **labhate** (attains).

*Kṛṣṇa's mercy in the form of the *śikṣā-guru* —*

জীবে সাক্ষাৎ নাহি তাতে গুরু চৈত্যরূপে ।
শিক্ষাগুরু হয় কৃষ্ণ মহান্তস্বরূপে ॥ ৫৮ ॥

jīve sākṣāt nāhi tāte guru caitya-rūpe
to the soul directly not (seen) therefore guru as the Indweller
śikṣā-guru haya kṛṣṇa mahānta-svarūpe
instructing guru is Kṛṣṇa as a great devotee in form

58 The soul cannot see Kṛṣṇa directly; therefore He is the guru within as the Indweller, and becomes the instructing guru in the form of a great devotee.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The indwelling guru abides as the *caitya*, that is, within the mind. So one cannot see Him directly, face to face. That is why Kṛṣṇa becomes the *śikṣā-guru* in the form of the *mahānta*, the best of devotees.

Anubhāṣya.

The conditioned jīva cannot see Kṛṣṇa directly. Therefore Kṛṣṇa awakens in the jīva's heart the discernment that leads to devotion to Kṛṣṇa, and so becomes the *caitya-śikṣā-guru*. And appearing as a *mahānta*, He becomes the *śikṣā-guru*.

*The need for the company of sādhus; the dharma, marks and nature of the sādhu-guru — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.26.26)*

ততো দুঃসঙ্গমুৎসৃজ্য সৎসু সজ্জেত বুদ্ধিমান্ ।
সন্ত এবাস্য ছিন্দন্তি মনোব্যাসঙ্গমুক্তিভিঃ ॥ ৫৯ ॥

tato duḥsaṅgam utsṛjya
therefore bad company having given up
satsu sajjeta buddhi-mān
with the saintly should associate the wise
santa evāsya chindanti
the saints alone his cut
mano-vyāsaṅgam uktibhiḥ
the mind's attachment by their words

59 "Therefore the wise should give up bad company and associate with the saintly, for the saints alone, by their words, cut through the attachments of his mind." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.26.26)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Therefore an intelligent person will give up bad company and associate with sādhus. With their good instructions the sādhus will cut all the bonds of his desires that are unfavourable to devotion.

Anubhāṣya.
Urvaśī left Purūravā and went away. Beside himself with grief, he lamented for a whole year; then he gained discernment and understood the fruits of bad company. Śrī Bhagavān tells this story to Uddhava:

tataḥ duḥsaṅgam (bad company: the company of women and of those who keep company with women) **utsṛjya** (leaving far behind) **buddhimān** (one who discerns *sat* from *asat*) **satsu sajjeta** (should associate wholeheartedly with Hari's detached servants) **santaḥ** ([for] the sādhus) **asya** (of one absorbed in sense objects) **mano-vyāsaṅgam** (the mind's perverse attachment) **uktibhiḥ** (by their good instructions) **chindanti** (destroy).

*The fruit of hearing *hari-kathā* in the company of sādhus: the awakening of faith, *bhāva* and prema — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.25.25)*

সতাং প্রসঙ্গান্মম বীর্য্যসংবিদো
ভবন্তি হৃৎকর্ণরসায়নাঃ কথাঃ ৷
তজ্জোষণাদাশ্বপবর্গবর্ত্মনি
শ্রদ্ধা রতির্ভক্তিরনুক্রমিষ্যতি ॥ ৬০ ॥

satāṁ prasaṅgān mama vīrya-saṁvido
of the saints in the company My prowess revealing
bhavanti hṛt-karṇa-rasāyanāḥ kathāḥ
become to heart and ear delightful talks
taj-joṣaṇād āśv apavarga-vartmani
by relishing them quickly on the path of liberation
śraddhā ratir bhaktir anukramiṣyati
faith, attraction, love will follow in turn

60 (Lord Kapila to His mother Devahūti:) "In the company of the saints there are talks revealing My power, delightful to the heart and to the ear. By relishing them one quickly comes to faith in Me, the path of liberation, and after it to attraction (*rati*) and love (*prema-bhakti*)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.25.25)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the company of sādhus, narratives that reveal My power are discussed, an elixir for the heart and ears. As a person listens to them, there soon awakens in him faith in Me, the path of liberation; then *rati*; and at last loving devotion (*prema-bhakti*).

Anubhāṣya.

Devahūti asked her son Kapiladeva what her highest good was, and Kapila replied:

satām (of Hari's servants) **prasaṅgāt** (through excellent association) **mama vīrya-saṁvidaḥ** (those in which My power is rightly understood) **hṛt-karṇa-rasāyanāḥ** (an elixir for the heart and ears: delightful to hearing and mind, giving happiness) **kathāḥ bhavanti** (narratives arise) **taj-joṣaṇāt** (by serving them) **apavarga-vartmani** (towards Hari, on the path to whom ignorance ceases) **śraddhā** ([first] faith) **ratiḥ** ([then] *bhāva*) **bhaktiḥ** ([then] *prema*) **āśu** (soon) **anukramiṣyati** (will come one after another).

(First comes faith, then the company of sādhus. Through that company one hears these narratives, and an inclination to serve arises — the activity of worship. Then, through excellent association, come narratives that remove the *anarthas*, the unwanted things in the heart. Next these same narratives produce steadiness (*niṣṭhā*) and so let one understand My greatness. Then they produce taste (*ruci*) and become an elixir for the heart and ears. By serving these narratives and relishing them with love, there will come one after another: faith in Bhagavān,

which here means attachment (*āsakti*); *rati*, which is *bhāva*; and bhakti, which is *prema*.)

The truth about the Lord's devotees, and their kinds —

ঈশ্বরস্বরূপ ভক্ত তাঁর অধিষ্ঠান ।
ভক্তের হৃদয়ে কৃষ্ণের সতত বিশ্রাম ॥ ৬১ ॥

īśvara-svarūpa bhakta tāṁra adhiṣṭhāna
of the Lord own form the devotee His abode
bhaktera hṛdaye kṛṣṇera satata viśrāma
of the devotee in the heart of Kṛṣṇa always resting place

61 The devotee is the Lord's own form, His abode: in the devotee's heart Kṛṣṇa always rests.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Whoever is devoted to the Lord (*Īśvara*) in His form of eternal being, knowledge and bliss — that is, his heart — is the place where Kṛṣṇa dwells.

Anubhāṣya.
The one and only nondual reality is the Lord (*Īśvara*). This reality, the Lord, possesses all potencies. By nature the devotee is of the same kind as His potency, not of the same kind as the possessor of potency. The inclination to serve Kṛṣṇa lives in the devotee who worships Him. Therefore Kṛṣṇa abides in the devotee as His support.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 9.4.68)*

সাধবো হৃদয়ং মহ্যং সাধূনাং হৃদয়ন্ত্বহম্ ।
মদন্যত্তে ন জানন্তি নাহং তেভ্যো মনাগপি ॥ ৬২ ॥

sādhavo hṛdayaṁ mahyaṁ
the saints heart My
sādhūnāṁ hṛdayaṁ tv aham
of the saints heart indeed I
mad-anyat te na jānanti
other than Me they not know
nāhaṁ tebhyo manāg api
not I than them even slightly

62 "The saints are My heart, and I am the heart of the saints. They know no one but Me, and I know no one but them." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 9.4.68)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The sādhus are My heart, and I am the heart of the sādhus. They know no one but Me, and I regard no one but them as My own.

Anubhāṣya.
The sage Durvāsā offended the feet of the great devotee Mahārāja Ambarīṣa, and Viṣṇu's disc rushed forth to kill Durvāsā. He sought help from all the gods. At last Bhagavān Viṣṇu advised the sage Durvāsā to beg forgiveness at Ambarīṣa's lotus feet. In truth, with this verse He revealed the supreme greatness of the saintly devotees:

sādhavaḥ (the sādhus) **mahyam hṛdayam** (are My heart, as dear as My life) **sādhūnām tu aham hṛdayam** (and I am the heart of the sādhus) **te** (they, the sādhus) **mad-anyat** (anything other than Me) **na jānanti** (do not know) **aham** (and I) **tebhyaḥ** (apart from them) **manāg api** (even slightly) **anyat na** ([know] nothing else).

(The devotees always think of Me alone with all their being. And I always meditate on the devotees, who are wholly devoted to serving Me and have taken shelter at My feet with all their being.)

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.13.10)*

ভবদ্বিধা ভাগবতাস্তীর্থভূতাঃ স্বয়ং প্রভো ।
তীর্থীকুর্ব্বন্তি তীর্থানি স্বান্তঃস্থেন গদাভৃতা ॥ ৬৩ ॥

bhavad-vidhā bhāgavatās
like you devotees
tīrtha-bhūtāḥ svayaṁ prabho
holy places being yourselves, O lord
tīrthī-kurvanti tīrthāni
make holy the holy places
svāntaḥ-sthena gadā-bhṛtā
by Him within who bears the club

63 "Devotees such as you are themselves holy places, my lord. By the Lord who dwells within your hearts, you make even the holy places holy." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.13.10)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Devotees (*bhāgavatas*) like you are themselves holy places. The holy places are stained by the sins of sinners, and such devotees purify them by the holiness of Bhagavān, who dwells within them.

Anubhāṣya.
Vidura Mahāśaya had wandered through many holy places and returned to Hastināpura. Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira greeted him with this verse:

prabho (O lord) **bhavad-vidhāḥ** (those like you) **bhāgavatāḥ** (devotees, sādhus) **tīrtha-bhūtāḥ** (are themselves holy places) **svāntaḥ-sthena** (by Him who dwells within them) **gadābhṛtā** (by Bhagavān Viṣṇu) **tīrthāni** (the holy places, which through contact with impure people have ceased to be holy) **tīrthī-kurvanti** (make into great holy places again).

(And your pilgrimage is the good fortune of the holy places themselves.)

সেই ভক্তগণ হয় দ্বিবিধ প্রকার ।
পারিষদগণ এক, সাধকগণ আর ॥ ৬৪ ॥

sei bhakta-gaṇa haya dvi-vidha prakāra
those devotees are of two kinds
pāriṣad-gaṇa eka, sādhaka-gaṇa āra
associates one, practitioners other

64 These devotees are of two kinds: the Lord's eternal associates and those who practise devotion.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Devotees are of two kinds: Bhagavān's associates and practitioners (*sādhakas*). Bhagavān's associates are the circle of perfected servants (*siddha-sevakas*). Some of them are devoted to His majesty (*aiśvarya*) and dwell in the spiritual sky, Paravyoma. Others are devoted to His sweetness, *mādhurya*, and are absorbed in serving Kṛṣṇa in Śrī Vṛndāvana. The *sādhakas* are those who follow *vaidhī* or *rāgānugā sādhana-bhakti* in order to attain perfection in service.

The kinds of the Lord's avatāras —

ঈশ্বরের অবতার এ-তিন প্রকার ।
অংশ-অবতার, আর গুণ-অবতার ॥ ৬৫ ॥

শক্ত্যাবেশ-অবতার — তৃতীয় এমত ।
অংশ-অবতার — পুরুষ-মৎস্যাদিক যত ॥ ৬৬ ॥

īśvarera avatāra e-tina prakāra
of the Lord avatāras these three kinds
aṁśa-avatāra, āra guṇa-avatāra
partial avatāras, then guṇa-avatāras
śaktyāveśa-avatāra — tṛtīya e-mata
empowered avatāras — the third thus
aṁśa-avatāra — puruṣa-matsyādika yata
partial avatāras — the Puruṣas, Matsya and others all

65–66 The Lord's avatāras are of three kinds: partial avatāras, guṇa-avatāras, and, third, empowered avatāras. The partial avatāras are the Puruṣas, Matsya and the others.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *aṁśa-avatāras* are direct avatāras of Viṣṇu, masters of māyā. The *guṇa-avatāras* are avatāras of Bhagavān manifest in the three *guṇas*: *sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas*. The *śaktyāveśa-avatāras* are exalted jīvas whom a special potency of Kṛṣṇa enters.

ব্রহ্মা বিষ্ণু শিব — তিন গুণাবতারে গণি ।
শক্ত্যাবেশ — সনকাদি, পৃথু, ব্যাসমুনি ॥ ৬৭ ॥

brahmā viṣṇu śiva — tina guṇāvatāre gaṇi
Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Śiva — three as guṇa-avatāras are counted
śakty-āveśa — sanakādi, pṛthu, vyāsa-muni
empowered — the Kumāras, Pṛthu, Vyāsa the sage

67 Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Śiva are counted as the three guṇa-avatāras; the Kumāras, Pṛthu and the sage Vyāsa are empowered avatāras.

Anubhāṣya.
Īśvarera, "of the Lord," means of Kṛṣṇa in His original form (*svayaṁ-rūpa*). See the first part of the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, the section on the object of worship and on the avatāras, and also *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya-līlā, Chapter 20.

*The Lord's manifestations differ by *līlā* —*

দুইরূপে হয় ভগবানের প্রকাশ ।
একে ত' প্রকাশ হয়, আরে ত' বিলাস ॥ ৬৮ ॥

dui-rūpe haya bhagavānera prakāśa
in two forms is of the Lord manifestation
eke ta' prakāśa haya, āre ta' vilāsa
one indeed prakāśa is, the other vilāsa

68 The Lord manifests Himself in two ways: one is *prakāśa*, the other *vilāsa*.

Anubhāṣya.
Bhagavānera, "of Bhagavān": of His original form (*svayaṁ-rūpa*). See *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya-līlā, Chapter 20.

*The Lord's manifestation (*īśa-prakāśa*) —*

একই বিগ্রহ যদি হয় বহুরূপ ।
আকারে ত' ভেদ নাহি, একই স্বরূপ ॥ ৬৯ ॥

মহিষী-বিবাহে, যৈছে যৈছে কৈল রাস ।
ইহাকে কহিয়ে কৃষ্ণের মুখ্য ‘প্রকাশ’ ॥ ৭০ ॥

eka-i vigraha yadi haya bahu-rūpa
one and the same person if becomes many forms
ākāre ta’ bheda nāhi, eka-i svarūpa
in appearance no difference, one identity
mahiṣī-vivāhe, yaiche yaiche kaila rāsa
at the queens’ marriage, as as He did the rāsa
ihāke kahiye kṛṣṇera mukhya ‘prakāśa’
this is called Kṛṣṇa’s chief prakāśa

69–70 When one Person appears in many forms, alike in appearance and one in identity — as at the marriage of the queens or in the rāsa dance — this is called Kṛṣṇa’s chief *prakāśa*.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Bhagavān manifests in two ways: as *prakāśa* and as *vilāsa*. Kṛṣṇa displayed many forms at once when He married the queens in Dvārakā and when He danced the rāsa in Vṛndāvana. Those forms did not differ in shape: one and the same form (*vigraha*) became many. This is Kṛṣṇa’s principal *prakāśa*. But where the *svarūpa* takes another shape, one resembling itself, that manifestation is called *vilāsa*. Baladeva in Vṛndāvana, and Nārāyaṇa, Vāsudeva, Pradyumna, Saṅkarṣaṇa and others in Paravyoma, are *vilāsa* forms in which Bhagavān’s own form appears.

Anubhāṣya.

“A *prakāśa* is not counted among the distinct forms, for He is not separate from Him.” (*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, first part).

Anubhāṣya.

“As one body became many forms in the rāsa dance, so at His marriage to the queens He appeared in many forms. This is known in the scriptures as *prābhava-vilāsa*.”[12] (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya 20.168).

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.69.2)*

চিত্রং বতৈতদেকেন বপুষা যুগপৎ পৃথক্ ৷
গৃহেষু দ্ব্যষ্টসাহস্রং স্ত্রিয় এক উদাবহৎ ॥ ৭১ ॥

citraṁ bataitad ekena
wonderful indeed this with one
vapuṣā yugapat pṛthak
body at once separately
gṛheṣu dvy-aṣṭa-sāhasraṁ
in palaces sixteen thousand
striya eka udāvahat
women the One married

71 "How wonderful! The one Kṛṣṇa, in one and the same body, married sixteen thousand princesses at once, each in her own palace." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.69.2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
What is wonderful is this: the one Kṛṣṇa, each time in a single form, married sixteen thousand wives at once in separate palaces.

Anubhāṣya.
bata (oh!) **etat citram** (this is wonderful) **ekaḥ** (the one Kṛṣṇa) **ekena vapuṣā** (in a single body) **yugapat pṛthag gṛheṣu** (at once in separate palaces) **dvy-aṣṭa-sāhasram** (sixteen thousand) **striyaḥ** (queens) **udāvahat** (married).

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.33.3–5)*

রাসোৎসবঃ সংপ্রবৃত্তো গোপীমণ্ডলমণ্ডিতঃ ৷
যোগেশ্বরেণ কৃষ্ণেন তাসাং মধ্যে দ্বয়োর্দ্বয়োঃ ॥ ৭২ ॥

rāsotsavaḥ sampravṛtto
the rāsa festival began
gopī-maṇḍala-maṇḍitaḥ
with circles of gopīs adorned
yogeśvareṇa kṛṣṇena
by the Master of yoga Kṛṣṇa
tāsāṁ madhye dvayor dvayoḥ
of them between each two

72 "The festival of the rāsa dance began, adorned with circles of gopīs; Kṛṣṇa, the Master of yoga, stood between each two of them —" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.33.3)

প্রবিষ্টেন গৃহীতানাং কণ্ঠে স্বনিকটং স্ত্রিয়ঃ ।
যং মন্যেরন্নভস্তাবদ্বিমানশতসঙ্কুলম্ ॥ ৭৩ ॥

দিবৌকসাং সদারাণামত্যৌৎসুক্যভৃতাত্মনাম্ ।
ততো দুন্দুভয়ো নেদুর্নিপেতুঃ পুষ্পবৃষ্টয়ঃ ॥ ৭৪ ॥

praviṣṭena gṛhītānāṁ
having entered, of those embraced
kaṇṭhe sva-nikaṭaṁ striyaḥ
by the neck, beside her the women
yaṁ manyeran nabhas tāvad
whom would think; the sky at once
vimāna-śata-saṅkulam
with hundreds of celestial cars crowded
divaukasāṁ sa-dārāṇām
of the gods with their wives
atyautsukya-bhṛtātmanām
with intense eagerness filled in mind
tato dundubhayo nedur
then the drums sounded
nipetuḥ puṣpa-vṛṣṭayaḥ
fell showers of flowers

73–74 "— having entered between them and embraced each by the neck, so that every girl thought Him beside her alone. At once the sky was crowded with hundreds of celestial cars of the gods and their wives, their hearts filled with intense eagerness. Then the drums sounded and showers of flowers fell." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.33.3–4)[6]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the master of mystic power (*yogeśvara*), by His inconceivable potency manifested a form of Himself between every two gopīs. Adorned by the circle of gopīs, He began the festival of the rāsa. When He had entered among them in this way, the gopīs felt that Śrī Kṛṣṇa was embracing them, His arm about their necks. At that moment the gods and their wives appeared in the sky, having come eagerly on hundreds of chariots. Then kettledrums sounded and a rain of flowers began to fall.

Anubhāṣya.

tāsām (of them, standing in a circle) **dvayor dvayor madhye** (between each two) **praviṣṭena** (by Him who entered in a separate form) **yam** (Śrī Kṛṣṇa, whom) **svanikaṭam** (as being close to herself [that is, "He has embraced me alone"]) **manyeran** (they thought) **yogeśvareṇa** (by that Kṛṣṇa) **kaṇṭhe gṛhītānām** (of those embraced at the neck from both sides) **gopī-maṇḍala-maṇḍitaḥ** (adorned by the circle of gopīs) **rāsotsavaḥ sampravṛttaḥ** (the festival of the rāsa began) **tāvat** (at that very moment) **atyautsukya-bhṛtātmanām** (of those whose minds were deeply stirred by longing to see) **sa-dārāṇām** (with their wives) **divaukasām** (of the gods) **vimāna-śata-saṅkulam** (full, filled, crowded with hundreds of aerial chariots) **abhavat** ([the sky] became) **tataḥ dundubhayo nedur nipetuḥ puṣpavṛṣṭayaḥ** (then kettledrums sounded and showers of flowers fell).

*(*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, first part, 1.21)*

অনেকত্র প্রকটতা রূপস্যৈকস্য যৈকদা ।
সর্ব্বথা তৎস্বরূপৈব স প্রকাশ ইতীর্য্যতে ॥ ৭৫ ॥

anekatra prakaṭatā
in many places manifestation
rūpasyaikasya yaikadā
of form one which at one time
sarvathā tat-svarūpaiva
in every way identical in nature
sa prakāśa itīryate
that prakāśa is called

75 "When one form appears at one time in many places, identical in every way, that is called *prakāśa*." (Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, 1.21)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
When one form manifests at the same time as many identical forms, this is called *prakāśa*.

Anubhāṣya.
ekadā (at one time) **ekasya rūpasya** (of one form) **yā anekatra prakaṭatā** (the manifestation in many places) **sarvathā tat-svarūpaiva** (identical with it in nature in every way, that is, one in shape, qualities, *līlās* and the rest) **sa prakāśa itīryate** (is called *prakāśa*).

*The Lord's *vilāsa* (*īśa-vilāsa*) —*

একই বিগ্রহ যদি আকারে হয় আন ।
অনেক প্রকাশ হয়, 'বিলাস' তার নাম ॥ ৭৬ ॥

eka-i vigraha yadi ākāre haya āna
one and the same person if in appearance is different
aneka prakāśa haya, 'vilāsa' tāra nāma
many manifestations are, vilāsa its name

76 But when one and the same Person appears in many forms that differ in appearance, that is called *vilāsa*.

*(*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, in the description of the *tad-ekātma-rūpa*, 1.15)*

স্বরূপমন্যাকারং যত্তস্য ভাতি বিলাসতঃ ৷
প্রায়েণাত্মসমং শক্ত্যা স বিলাসো নিগদ্যতে ॥ ৭৭ ॥

svarūpam anyākāraṁ yat
His own form of different shape which
tasya bhāti vilāsataḥ
of Him appears for pastimes
prāyeṇātma-samaṁ śaktyā
almost equal to Him by His potency
sa vilāso nigadyate
that vilāsa is called

77 "When by His potency His own form appears for His pastimes in a different shape, almost equal to Him, it is called *vilāsa*." (Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, 1.15)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
When, in the play of His inconceivable potency, His own form appears in another shape, almost like Himself, it is called *vilāsa*.

Anubhāṣya.
tasya (of the original form) **yat svarūpam anyākāram** (a *svarūpa* different in shape, that is, with a different arrangement of the limbs) **vilāsataḥ** (through a particular *līlā*) **prāyeṇa** (less or greater in certain qualities) **ātma-samam** (like its own original form) **śaktyā bhāti** (appears by potency) **sa vilāso nigadyate** (is called *vilāsa*).

যৈছে বলদেব, পরব্যোমে নারায়ণ ৷
যৈছে বাসুদেব প্রদ্যুম্নাদি সঙ্কর্ষণ ॥ ৭৮ ॥

yaiche baladeva, paravyome nārāyaṇa
as Baladeva, in the spiritual sky Nārāyaṇa
yaiche vāsudeva pradyumnādi saṅkarṣaṇa
as Vāsudeva, Pradyumna and others, Saṅkarṣaṇa

78 Examples are Baladeva, Nārāyaṇa in the spiritual sky, and Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and the others.

Anubhāṣya.

Baladeva is *svayaṁ-prakāśa*. Nārāyaṇa is *prābhava-vilāsa*.

*The Lord's potency (*īśa-śakti*) —*

ঈশ্বরের শক্তি হয় ত্রিবিধ প্রকার ।
এক লক্ষ্মীগণ, পুরে মহিষীগণ আর ॥ ৭৯ ॥

ব্রজে গোপীগণ আর সবাতে প্রধান ।
ব্রজেন্দ্রনন্দন যা'তে স্বয়ং ভগবান্ ॥ ৮০ ॥

īśvarera śakti haya trividha prakāra
of the Lord potencies are of three kinds
eka lakṣmī-gaṇa, pure mahiṣī-gaṇa āra
one the Lakṣmīs, in the city the queens another
vraje gopī-gaṇa āra sabāte pradhāna
in Vraja the gopīs and of all the chief
vrajendra-nandana yā'te svayaṁ bhagavān
Vraja's king's son since in them Himself Bhagavān

79–80 The Lord's potencies are of three kinds: the Lakṣmīs in Vaikuṇṭha, the queens in Dvārakā, and the gopīs in Vraja. The gopīs are the foremost of all, for with them the son of the king of Vraja is Bhagavān Himself.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Lakṣmīs dwell in Vaikuṇṭha, the queens in the city, that is, in Dvārakā, and the gopīs in Vraja are the third kind of potency. *Sabāte* means "among all." *Yāte* means "since": since Vrajendranandana, the son of the king of Vraja, is Bhagavān Himself. His companions in Vraja are His very own potency (*svarūpa-śakti*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

From *yadyapi āmāra guru* ("although my guru," verse 44) to *sādhaka-gaṇa āra* ("and the others are practitioners," verse 64): the examination of two truths, the guru and the devotee. From *īśvarera avatāra* ("the Lord's avatāras," verse 65) to *pṛthu vyāsa muni* ("Pṛthu and the sage Vyāsa," verse 67): the examination of the

Lord and His avatāras. From *dui-rūpe haya* (“is of two kinds,” verse 68) to *pradyumnādi-saṅkarṣaṇa* (“Pradyumna and the others, Saṅkarṣaṇa,” verse 78): the examination of His *prakāśa* and *vilāsa*. Then from *īśvarera śakti haya* (“the Lord’s potencies are,” verse 79) to *svayaṁ bhagavān* (“Bhagavān Himself,” verse 80): the examination of His potencies.

স্বয়ংরূপ কৃষ্ণের কায়ব্যূহ — তাঁর সম ।
ভক্ত সহিতে হয় তাঁহার আবরণ ॥ ৮১ ॥

svayaṁ-rūpa kṛṣṇera kāya-vyūha — tāṁra sama
Kṛṣṇa’s original form’s bodily expansions — His equals
bhakta sahite haya tāṁhāra āvaraṇa
the devotees together with are His entourage

81 The expansions of the body of Kṛṣṇa’s original form are equal to Him, and together with the devotees they form His entourage.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Svayaṁ-rūpa: the verses of the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* on *tad-ekātma* and related forms show that the two-armed Kṛṣṇa alone is the *svayaṁ-rūpa*. His *kāya-vyūha* is equal to Him; *kāya-vyūha* means the expansion of His own body. The devotees who stand beside this form are His *āvaraṇa*. When we consider the *āvaraṇa* together with the truth it surrounds, the six truths named above prove to be one. This conclusion is established only by considering *acintya-bhedābheda-tattva*.

ভক্ত আদি ক্রমে কৈল সবার বন্দন ।
এ-সবার বন্দন সর্ব্ব শুভের কারণ ॥ ৮২ ॥

bhakta ādi krame kaila sabāra vandana
devotees and the rest in order I made of all worship
e-sabāra vandana sarva śubhera kāraṇa
of these all worship of every good the cause

82 Thus, beginning with the devotees, I have worshipped them all in order; worship of them all is the source of every good.

প্রথম শ্লোকে সামান্য মঙ্গলাচরণ ।
দ্বিতীয় শ্লোকেতে করি বিশেষ বন্দন ॥ ৮৩ ॥

prathama śloke sāmānya maṅgalācaraṇa
in the first verse general invocation
dvitīya ślokete kari viśeṣa vandana
in the second verse I make specific worship

83 In the first verse is the general invocation; in the second I offer specific worship.

Explanation of the second of the opening fourteen verses —

বন্দে শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্যনিত্যানন্দৌ সহোদিতৌ ।
গৌড়োদয়ে পুষ্পবন্তৌ চিত্রৌ শন্দৌ তমোনুদৌ ॥ ৮৪ ॥

vande śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-
I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya
nityānandau sahoditau
and Nityānanda who rose together
gauḍodaye puṣpavantau
on the eastern horizon of Gauḍa the sun and moon
citrau śan-dau tamo-nudau
wonderful bestowing good dispelling darkness

84 I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Śrī Nityānanda, who are like a wonderful sun and moon. They have risen together on the eastern horizon of Gauḍa, dispelling the darkness and bestowing good on all.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Nityānanda. Like the sun and the moon, They have risen wondrously at the same time in the land of Gauḍa, which is like Udayācala, the mountain of sunrise. They bestow good fortune and dispel the darkness of the jīvas.

Anubhāṣya.
gauḍodaye (in the land of Gauḍa, which is the Udayācala, the mountain of sunrise) **sahoditau** (risen at the same time) **puṣpavantau** (the sun and the moon together;

and therefore —) **citrau** (wondrous) **śan-dau** (bestowing good fortune) **tamo-nudau** (dispelling darkness) **śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-nityānandau** (Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Nityānanda) **aham vande** (I worship).

**Gauḍodaye puṣpavantau* —*

ব্রজে যে বিহরে পূর্ব্বে কৃষ্ণ-বলরাম ।
কোটীসূর্য্যচন্দ্র জিনি' দোঁহার নিজধাম ॥ ৮৫ ॥

সেই দুই জগতেরে হইয়ে সদয় ।
গৌড়দেশে পূর্ব্বশৈলে করিল উদয় ॥ ৮৬ ॥

vraje ye vihare pūrve kṛṣṇa-balarāma
in Vraja who sported before Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma
koṭī-sūrya-candra jini' doṁhāra nija-dhāma
millions of suns and moons surpassing of both own effulgence
sei dui jagatere haiye sadaya
those Two to the world becoming compassionate
gauḍadeśe pūrva-śaile karila udaya
in Gauḍa land on the eastern mountain have risen

85–86 Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma, who sported in Vraja long ago, Their radiance surpassing millions of suns and moons, have now, out of compassion for the world, risen on the eastern horizon in the land of Gauḍa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Nija-dhāma: radiance.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Pūrva-śaile, "on the eastern mountain": on the Udayācala that is Gauḍa, on the eastern bank of the Gaṅgā.

শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য আর প্রভু নিত্যানন্দ ।
যাঁহার প্রকাশে সর্ব্ব জগৎ আনন্দ ॥ ৮৭ ॥

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya āra prabhu nityānanda
Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Prabhu Nityānanda
yāṁhāra prakāśe sarva jagat ānanda
whose by the appearance the whole world joyful

87 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Prabhu Nityānanda — by Their appearance the whole world is filled with joy.

An example of causeless mercy —

সূর্য্যচন্দ্র হরে যৈছে সব অন্ধকার ।
বস্তু প্রকাশিয়া করে ধর্ম্মের প্রচার ॥ ৮৮ ॥

এইমত দুই ভাই জীবের অজ্ঞান-
তমোনাশ করি' কৈল তত্ত্ববস্তু-দান ॥ ৮৯ ॥

sūrya-candra hare yaiche saba andhakāra
the sun and moon remove as all darkness
vastu prakāśiyā kare dharmera pracāra
things revealing make of duty the spreading
ei mata dui bhāi jīvera ajñāna-
in this way the two brothers of the soul of ignorance
tamo-nāśa kari' kaila tattva-vastu-dāna
the darkness destroying made of the Truth the gift

88–89 As the sun and moon remove all darkness and, revealing things, set the world about its duties, so these two Brothers dispelled the darkness of the soul's ignorance and gave it the gift of the Truth.

*The definition of *kaitava* (cheating) —*

অজ্ঞান-তমের নাম কহিয়ে 'কৈতব' ।
ধর্ম্ম-অর্থ-কাম-বাঞ্ছা আদি এই সব ॥ ৯০ ॥

ajñāna-tamera nāma kahiye 'kaitava'
of ignorance of the darkness the name I call 'deceit'
dharma-artha-kāma-vāñchā ādi ei saba
religiosity, wealth, pleasure desire and so on these all

90 I call this darkness of ignorance *kaitava*, deceit: it is the desire for religious merit, wealth, pleasure and the rest.[7]

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.1.2)*

ধর্ম্মঃ প্রোজ্ঝিতকৈতবোঽত্র পরমো নির্ম্মৎসরাণাং সতাং
বেদ্যং বাস্তবমত্র বস্তু শিবদং তাপত্রয়োন্মূলনম্ ৷
শ্রীমদ্ভাগবতে মহামুনিকৃতে কিংবাপরৈরীশ্বরঃ
সদ্যো হৃদ্যবরুধ্যতেঽত্র কৃতিভিঃ শুশ্রূষুভিস্তৎক্ষণাৎ ॥ ৯১ ॥

dharmaḥ projjhita-kaitavo ʻtra paramo nirmatsarāṇāṁ satāṁ
dharma wholly-cast-out deceit here supreme of the non-envious of the saints
vedyaṁ vāstavam atra vastu śiva-daṁ tāpa-trayonmūlanam
to be known real here substance bestowing good the threefold miseries uprooting
śrīmad-bhāgavate mahā-muni-kṛte kiṁ vā parair īśvaraḥ
in the beautiful Bhāgavata by the great sage composed what by others? the Lord
sadyo hṛdy avarudhyate ʻtra kṛtibhiḥ śuśrūṣubhis tat-kṣaṇāt
at once in the heart is captured here by the pious who wish to hear that very moment

91 "In this beautiful *Bhāgavatam*, composed by the great sage, is taught the supreme dharma of the saintly who are free from envy, from which all deceit has been cast out. Here is known the true Reality, which bestows good and uproots the threefold miseries. What need is there of other scriptures? As soon as the pious wish to hear it, the Lord is at once captured within their hearts." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.1.2)[8]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

This *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* was first composed by the great sage Śrī Nārāyaṇa in the form of four verses (*catuḥ-ślokī*). It sets forth the highest dharma for those free from envy, that is, kind to all beings. This dharma is free from cheating (*kaitava*), and that cheating includes dharma, *artha*, *kāma* and even *mokṣa*. It destroys the threefold miseries of the jīva, bestows good fortune and gives knowledge of the true reality. Those who wish to hear the *Bhāgavatam* can

hold the Lord captive in their hearts at will. What need, then, is there for any scripture other than the *Bhāgavatam*?

Anubhāṣya.

mahā-muni-kṛte (composed by the great sage Śrī Nārāyaṇa) **atra śrīmad-bhāgavate** (in this beautiful *Bhāgavata*) **projjhita-kaitavaḥ** (that from which cheating has been entirely cast out: so *pra-* and *ujjhita* are understood. The cheating is hypocrisy made up of dharma, *artha*, *kāma* and *mokṣa* and marked by the pursuit of results. The mark of this dharma is service to Bhagavān alone) **satām** (of Hari's servants) **nirmatsarāṇām** (free from lust, anger, greed, delusion, pride and envy) **paramaḥ** (the highest, for its aim is to set aside the scriptures of karma and jñāna) **dharmaḥ** (dharma [is described]) **atra** (in the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*) **tāpa-trayonmūlanam** (uprooting the sins that bring suffering from one's own body and mind, from other beings and from the forces of nature) **śivadam** (bestowing good fortune) **vāstavam** (eternal, supreme, nondual) **vastu vedyam** (the reality to be known) **atra** (in the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*) **śuśrūṣubhiḥ** (by those who wish to hear) **kṛtibhiḥ** (by those endowed with pious merit) **hṛdi tat-kṣaṇāt** (in the heart at once) **sadyaḥ** (without any delay) **īśvaraḥ avarudhyate** (the Lord is held captive).

তার মধ্যে মোক্ষবাঞ্ছা কৈতব-প্রধান ।
যাহা হৈতে কৃষ্ণভক্তি হয় অন্তর্দ্ধান ॥ ৯২ ॥

tāra madhye mokṣa-vāñchā kaitava-pradhāna
of them among liberation's desire deceit's chief
yāhā haite kṛṣṇa-bhakti haya antardhāna
from which Kṛṣṇa devotion is disappearance

92 Among them the chief deceit is the desire for liberation, by which devotion to Kṛṣṇa disappears.

Śrīdhara Svāmī's comment on this verse —

"প্র-শব্দেন মোক্ষাভিসন্ধিরপি নিরস্তঃ" ইতি ॥ ৯৩ ॥

"pra-śabdena mokṣābhisandhir api nirastaḥ" iti
by the word 'pra' of liberation the intention also is excluded thus

93 "By the prefix *pra* even the intention of liberation is excluded."[9]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Among these, the chief cheating is the desire for liberation (*mukti*). That is why Svāmipāda pointed out that the prefix *pra-* means freedom even from the cheating that consists in aiming at liberation.

কৃষ্ণভক্তির বাধক — যত শুভাশুভ কর্ম্ম ।
সেই এক জীবের অজ্ঞানতমো-ধর্ম্ম ॥ ৯৪ ॥

kṛṣṇa-bhaktira bādhaka — yata śubhāśubha karma
to Kṛṣṇa-bhakti obstacles — all good and bad deeds
sei eka jīvera ajñāna-tamo-dharma
that one of the soul of ignorance darkness' nature

94 All good and bad deeds that obstruct devotion to Kṛṣṇa also belong to the soul's darkness of ignorance.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda, the two brothers, are like the sun and the moon. Rising, They destroy the darkness in the hearts of the jīvas. The meaning of these verses is this. The jīva is by nature a spiritual truth. The jīva's own original nature (*svadharma*) is devotion to Kṛṣṇa and love for Kṛṣṇa. Pious action (*puṇya*), sinful action (*pāpa*) and the aim of liberation have entered the jīva in the guise of his own nature and filled him with the qualities of darkness (*tamo-dharma*). All teachings that establish karma and jñāna are *kaitava*, cheating, and therefore serve the qualities of darkness. Before Caitanya and Nityānanda rose, these qualities of darkness polluted the hearts of the jīvas. The two brothers rose, drove the darkness out of the cave of the jīvas' hearts and revealed the true reality (*vastu-tattva*).

The fruit of Nitāi and Gaura's mercy —

যাঁহার প্রসাদে এই তমো হয় নাশ ।
তমো নাশ করি' করে তত্ত্বের প্রকাশ ॥ ৯৫ ॥

yāṁhāra prasāde ei tamo haya nāśa
whose by the grace this darkness is destroyed
tamo nāśa kari' kare tattvera prakāśa
darkness destroying make of the Truth the revelation

95 By Their grace this darkness is destroyed, and, destroying it, They reveal the Truth.

*What the true reality (*tattva-vastu*) is —*

তত্ত্ববস্তু — কৃষ্ণ, কৃষ্ণভক্তি, প্রেমরূপ ।
নামসংকীর্ত্তন — সর্ব্ব আনন্দস্বরূপ ॥ ৯৬ ॥

tattva-vastu — kṛṣṇa, kṛṣṇa-bhakti, prema-rūpa
the Truth — Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa-bhakti in the form of love
nāma-saṅkīrtana — sarva ānanda-svarūpa
the Name's congregational chanting — all bliss embodiment

96 The Truth is Kṛṣṇa, devotion to Kṛṣṇa in the form of pure love (prema), and the congregational chanting of the Holy Name, the embodiment of all bliss.

How They surpass the sun and the moon —

সূর্য্য চন্দ্র বাহিরের তমঃ সে বিনাশে ।
বহির্ব্বস্তু ঘট পট আদি সে প্রকাশে ॥ ৯৭ ॥

sūrya candra bāhirera tamaḥ se vināśe
the sun the moon external darkness they destroy
bahir-vastu ghaṭa paṭa ādi se prakāśe
external things pots cloth and so on they reveal

97 The sun and moon dispel the outer darkness and reveal outer things — pots, cloth and the like.

দুই ভাই হৃদয়ের ক্ষালি' অন্ধকার ।
দুই ভাগবত-সঙ্গে করান সাক্ষাৎকার ॥ ৯৮ ॥

dui bhāi hṛdayera kṣāli' andhakāra
the two brothers of the heart washing away the darkness
dui bhāgavata-saṅge karāna sākṣātkāra
two bhāgavatas with bring about meeting

98 But the two Brothers wash away the darkness of the heart and bring one to meet the two *bhāgavatas*.

এক ভাগবত বড় — ভাগবতশাস্ত্র ।
আর ভাগবত — ভক্ত ভক্তি-রস-পাত্র ॥ ৯৯ ॥

eka bhāgavata baḍa — bhāgavata-śāstra
one bhāgavata great — the Bhāgavata scripture
āra bhāgavata — bhakta bhakti-rasa-pātra
another bhāgavata — the devotee of devotion's rasa the vessel

99 One *bhāgavata* is the great scripture *Bhāgavatam*; the other *bhāgavata* is the devotee, the vessel of the rasa of devotion.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"The two *bhāgavatas*" are the scripture *Bhāgavatam* and the devotee *bhāgavata*, the vessel of the rasa of devotion. The brothers let the jīvas meet these two face to face, gave them the rasa of devotion, and were conquered by the jīvas' love.

দুই ভাগবত দ্বারা দিয়া ভক্তিরস ।
তাঁহার হৃদয়ে তাঁর প্রেমে হয় বশ ॥ ১০০ ॥

dui bhāgavata dvārā diyā bhakti-rasa
two bhāgavatas through giving devotion's rasa
tāṁhāra hṛdaye tāṁra preme haya vaśa
his in the heart by his love is subdued

100 Through these two *bhāgavatas* They give the rasa of devotion, and the Lord, dwelling in the devotee's heart, is held captive by his love.

Citrau —

এক অদ্ভুত — সমকালে দোঁহার প্রকাশ ।
আর অদ্ভুত — চিত্তগুহার তমঃ করে নাশ ॥ ১০১ ॥

eka adbhuta — sama-kāle doṁhāra prakāśa
one wonder — at the same time of both the appearance
āra adbhuta — citta-guhāra tamaḥ kare nāśa
another wonder — of the heart's cave the darkness make destruction

101 One wonder is that the Two appeared at the same time; the other wonder is that They destroy the darkness in the cave of the heart.

এই চন্দ্র সূর্য্য দুই পরম সদয় ।
জগতের ভাগ্যে গৌড়ে করিল উদয় ॥ ১০২ ॥

ei candra sūrya dui parama sadaya
this moon sun both supremely kind
jagatera bhāgye gauḍe karila udaya
of the world for the fortune in Gauḍa have risen

102 This moon and sun, supremely kind, have risen in Gauḍa for the good fortune of the world.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Jagatera bhāgye, "for the good fortune of the world": the two brothers preached the dharma of love, and it will gradually spread throughout this world. This is the world's good fortune.

Gauḍe, "in Gauḍa": the kings of the Sena dynasty moved the throne of their empire to the region of Śrī Navadvīpa from the ancient city of Gauḍa in the Maldah district. That is why the region of Śrī Navadvīpa is called the land of Gauḍa. In this Gauḍa, on the eastern bank of the Gaṅgā, Mahāprabhu was born. Nityānanda Prabhu came there and joined Him, and together They rose.

**Śan-dau* —*

সেই দুই প্রভুর করি চরণ বন্দন ।
যাঁহা হইতে বিঘ্ননাশ অভীষ্টপূরণ ॥ ১০৩ ॥

sei dui prabhura kari caraṇa vandana
of these two Lords I make of the feet worship
yāṁhā haite vighna-nāśa abhīṣṭa-pūraṇa
from which obstacles' destruction, desires' fulfilment

103 I worship the feet of these two Lords, from whom come the destruction of obstacles and the fulfilment of desire.

এই দুই শ্লোকে কৈল মঙ্গল বন্দন ।
তৃতীয় শ্লোকের অর্থ শুন সর্ব্বজন ॥ ১০৪ ॥

ei dui śloke kaila maṅgala vandana
in these two verses I made auspicious worship
tṛtīya ślokera artha śuna sarva-jana
of the third verse the meaning hear all people

104 In these two verses I have made the auspicious worship; now, all of you, hear the meaning of the third verse.

বক্তব্য-বাহুল্য, গ্রন্থ-বিস্তারের ডরে ।
বিস্তারি' না বর্ণি সারার্থ কহি অল্পাক্ষরে ॥ ১০৫ ॥

vaktavya-bāhulya, grantha-vistārera ḍare
of what must be said the abundance, of the book the expansion in fear
vistāri' nā varṇi sārārtha kahi alpākṣare
in detail not I describe; the essence I tell in few words

105 Fearing the abundance of what could be said and the swelling of the book, I do not describe it at length; I tell the essence in few words.

(A saying of the ancients in their own scriptures, established by immemorial

usage) —

'মিতঞ্চ সারঞ্চ বচো হি বাগ্মিতা' ইতি ॥ ১০৬ ॥

'mitañ ca sārañ ca vaco hi vāgmitā' iti
measured and essential and speech indeed eloquence thus

106 "Speech that is measured and essential is true eloquence."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Eloquence means speech of few words, full of substance.

Anubhāṣya.
mitam ca (free of idle talk, only to the point) **sāram ca** (pointing to the essence) **vacaḥ hi vāgmitā** (such speech is eloquence, the skill of speaking).

**Śan-dau* —*

শুনিলে খণ্ডিবে চিত্তের অজ্ঞানাদি দোষ ।
কৃষ্ণে গাঢ় প্রেম হবে, পাইবে সন্তোষ ॥ ১০৭ ॥

śunile khaṇḍibe cittera ajñānādi doṣa
by hearing will be cut of the heart ignorance and other faults
kṛṣṇe gāḍha prema habe, pāibe santoṣa
for Kṛṣṇa deep love will come, will obtain satisfaction

107 By hearing this, one's heart will be freed from ignorance and other faults; deep love for Kṛṣṇa will arise, and one will find true satisfaction.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Instead of *kṛṣṇe gāḍha prema habe* ("there will be deep love for Kṛṣṇa"), a variant reading has *sarva-tattva jñāna haibe* ("there will be knowledge of all truths").

Thus ends the first chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

Anubhāṣya.
The *Mahābhārata* (Udyoga-parva, Chapter 43, verse 16) names twelve kinds of faults, and the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* eighteen. The difficulty of knowing the *svarūpa*: (1) *ajñāna*, ignorance — the notion "I am the material body"; (2) *viparyāsa*, inversion — the conceit of being an enjoyer of matter; (3) *bheda*, division — ab-

sorption in a second thing; (4) fear, and taking on a distorted form; (5) grief. These five are ignorance.

The subject the book describes —

শ্রীচৈতন্য-নিত্যানন্দ-অদ্বৈত-মহত্ত্ব ।
তাঁর ভক্ত-ভক্তি-নাম-প্রেমরসতত্ত্ব ॥ ১০৮ ॥

ভিন্ন ভিন্ন লিখিয়াছি করিয়া বিচার ।
শুনিলে জানিবে সব বস্তুতত্ত্বসার ॥ ১০৯ ॥

śrī-caitanya-nityānanda-advaita-mahattva
Śrī Caitanya's, Nityānanda's, Advaita's greatness
tāṁra bhakta-bhakti-nāma-prema-rasa-tattva
Their devotees, devotion, Name, of love's rasa the truth
bhinna bhinna likhiyāchi kariyā vicāra
separately separately I have written having considered
śunile jānibe saba vastu-tattva-sāra
by hearing will know all of the Truth the essence

108–109 The greatness of Śrī Caitanya, Nityānanda and Advaita, Their devotees, devotion, the Holy Name and the truth of the rasa of prema — I have written of each separately, after careful consideration. Whoever hears it will know the essence of all Truth.

Anubhāṣya.
Thus ends the first chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ১১০ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
Śrī Rūpa's, Raghunātha's at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
"Caitanya-caritāmṛta" narrates Kṛṣṇadāsa

110 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. According to the *Anubhāṣya* (on 1.34): the gurus are Śrī Nityānanda, Śrī Raghunātha, Śrī Rūpa and others; the devotees — Śrīvāsa and others; the avatāras — Śrī Advaita and others; the manifestations — Śrī Nityānanda and others; the potencies — Śrī Gadādhara, Svarūpa Dāmodara, Jagadānanda and others. “Known as Kṛṣṇa Caitanya” qualifies the Lord Himself (*īśam*). The verse is explained in 1.32–1.82. ↩
2. According to the *Anubhāṣya* (on Ādi 7.6): the devotee in form is Śrī Gaurāṅga, who tastes His own sweetness; the devotee in essence (in the form of His brother) is Śrī Nityānanda; the devotee-avatāra is Śrī Advaita; the devotee is Śrīvāsa and others; the potency is Gadādhara, Svarūpa Dāmodara, Rāmānanda and others. Ascribed in the edition to Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī. ↩
3. Bengali text as in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «শাস্ত্র যে মত নিরূপণ». ↩
4. According to the *Anubhāṣya*: the knowledge is *sambandha*; the secret (*rahasya*) is prema-bhakti; its limb (*aṅga*) is sādhana-bhakti — hearing and the rest; all this the Lord speaks out of mercy, though Brahmā did not ask. ↩
5. According to the *Anubhāṣya*: Cintāmaṇi is the guru who showed the path (*śravaṇa-guru*), Somagiri the mantra-guru, and Kṛṣṇa the *caitya-śikṣā-guru*; *jayaśrī* is Vṛndāvaneśvarī; *līlā-svayaṁvara-rasa* — the joy of choosing Him out of deep love. ↩
6. The Bengali reading of 1.74 follows the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition, «অত্যৌৎসুক্যভৃতাত্মনাম্», which the *Anubhāṣya* glosses: “their minds greatly agitated by the eagerness to see”. ↩
7. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads «…বাঞ্ছা আদি এই সব» (“and so on”). ↩
8. The verse says only «শ্রীমদ্ভাগবতে মহামুনিকৃতে» (*śrīmad-bhāgavate mahā-muni-kṛte*), “in the beautiful *Bhāgavata* composed by the great sage”; the sage is not named. ↩
9. Śrīdhara Svāmī’s comment on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.1.2 (heading in the edition). ↩
10. Our verse translation of 1.57 reads differently: it takes Cintāmaṇi and Somagiri as two different gurus, whereas for Bhaktivinoda *cintāmaṇi* is a simile for Somagiri. (The *Anubhāṣya* on this verse likewise distinguishes them: Cintāmaṇi showed the way, Somagiri was the initiating guru.) ↩

11. The edition has «রাজহসৌ প্রজাতীতিবৎ»: the «হ» is the *avagraha* (ঽ), as usual in this edition («রাজাঽসৌ», *rājā 'sau*), while «প্রজাতীতিবৎ» is a misprint for «প্রয়াতীতিবৎ» (*prayātīti-vat*): “as [one says] ‘the king is setting out’,” meaning his retinue as well; compare the same example in Śrīdhara Svāmī’s commentary on *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.9.32. ↩
12. The quotation in the *Anubhāṣya* is made up of lines from CC Madhya 20.168, in a different order and with the reading *prābhava-vilāsa* (the VCD translation of that verse has *prābhava*). ↩